

Name: _____



New York State Testing Program

English Language Arts Test Session 1

Grade 8

Spring 2026

RELEASED QUESTIONS

Session 1



TIPS FOR TAKING THE TEST

Here are some ideas to help you do your best:

- Read the whole passage before you answer the questions. Most questions will only make sense after you read the whole passage.
- You might need to read the passage more than once to answer a question.
- Read each question carefully. Take your time.
- A question may include a quote from a passage. You might need to review both the quote and the whole passage to answer the question.

When you write your answers

- make sure to answer the whole question;
- use examples or details from the text;
- write in complete sentences; and
- use correct spelling, grammar, capitalization, and punctuation.

***D*irections**

Read this story. Then answer questions 1 through 7.

Fourteen-year-old Will has made a home for himself on an island overgrown with wild plants in the middle of the Mississippi River. He believes the island is deserted.

Excerpt from *Ferret Island*

by Richard W. Jennings

1 From where I stood in the sandy silt, my new home was an unkempt wilderness that stretched as far as the eye could see, which was maybe fifty feet before the tangled vegetation obscured everything.

2 A great blue heron landed on a gnarled branch of a nearby willow tree, startling me and scattering a flock of red-winged blackbirds. A bullfrog, hidden in the rushes, voiced a loud complaint. . . .

3 Pushing inland, I came to a clearing ringed with blackberry bushes. The grass was soft beneath my feet. Red and white clover, black-eyed Susans, Queen Anne's lace, and tiny, heart-shaped violets dotted the pocket meadow like daubs of pigment in a painting by some famous Frenchman.

4 *Ah, I thought, failing to note the significance of the crisscross pattern of beaten grass. I can make camp here.*

5 It was slow going, but using my hands, I fashioned a lean-to from willow whips—slender, limber branches torn from the trees that grew along the river. My house looked like a great upended nest. As much as it was shelter, it was also camouflage. Once inside, I was hidden from view. . . .

6 But what would I do about supplies?

7 The river provided the solution.

8 The mighty Mississippi drains more than half of the North American continent. Its tributaries stretch from within spitting distance of the Atlantic Ocean to the foothills of the towering Rockies, and through this vast network of natural plumbing flows a non-stop stream of an affluent nation's trash, a water-logged thrift store of the unwanted, outgrown, misplaced, and swept away.

9 On the Mississippi River, if you keep your eyes peeled, whatever you're likely to need will eventually pass by. Conveniently, some of it will wash ashore. . . .

GO ON

- 10 *All and all*, I assured myself, *this is a pretty nice place to be*.
- 11 I did begin to get lonely—not that I was missing anybody special. On these occasions, a nap would help. So would conversation with the local wildlife.
- 12 The heron in particular seemed to take a liking to me. He'd be at the water's edge every morning, hunting crayfish, minnows, and frogs, and he'd pause to give me a once-over before getting back to work. At sunset, he'd return to the same spot. . . .
- 13 I named him Moses.
- 14 At the river's edge, I found a lot of useful stuff. I dragged a chest of drawers to my hideout, and a picnic cooler that still contained ice. I found a set of canisters, a bookshelf, a wicker wastebasket, a brass antelope, and a chipped yellow flowerpot. One morning a brown leather Barcalounger washed up, with a library book—a murder mystery—stuck in the seat cushion. I spent the afternoon reclining in the sun and reading. . . .
- 15 It wasn't long before I'd salvaged so many things that I had to add an addition to my house. Using a Swiss Army knife, I cut and wove willow switches into a geodesic dome¹ that I subdivided into three rooms with curved walls and a soaring ten-foot ceiling.
- 16 To complete the homey feeling, I stuck a mailbox out front. This, too, had washed ashore in relatively good condition, except for a few rust spots along its seams and the name FITCH in faded letters on the sides.
- 17 *Oh, well*, I thought. *When you're the only person for miles around, Fitch is as good a name as any*.
- 18 What I did not know at the time is that *fitch* is the word for ferret fur.
- 19 One morning, while Moses was standing guard atop the tallest tree, I noticed that some of my things were missing: a deck of cards, a lighter, a calculator with a dead battery. I searched everywhere for them, but the fact is, when you live in a compact space, it doesn't take long to conduct a thorough inventory. . . .
- 20 A few days later, it happened again. A slotted spoon, a fishing cork, a set of keys, a rubber stamp that said RUSH, and a clock without a minute hand had disappeared while I slept.
- 21 *Enough's enough!* I said to myself.
- 22 That night, I set a trap for the thief. On top of my chest of drawers, I placed a purple drawstring bag filled with polished pieces of colored glass—dragon's tears, they're called—opening it just enough to let a few of the faux jewels spill out.
- 23 In the moonlight, they glittered like diamonds, rubies, and emeralds—surely an irresistible temptation for the common cat burglar. My plan would have worked, too, if I hadn't dozed off sometime before midnight. When I awoke, Moses was on the river, the sun was coming up, and the dragon's tears were gone. . . .

- 24 The next night, I laid out my coin collection—a Vermont quarter, three dimes, a
Lewis and Clark nickel, and six pennies—then stationed myself outside, behind a tree,
where I could observe the entrance to my hut.
- 25 I didn't have long to wait.
- 26 Making no more noise than a shadow, a long, dark form, like a soldier inching on his
belly toward enemy lines, slunk along the ground.
- 27 Frozen, I watched it as it slipped inside. My heart racing, I tiptoed toward the
entrance, not daring to breathe. A soft *clink-clink* sound from my bedroom told me that the
thief had found the money.
- 28 I picked up a croquet mallet, its hardwood handle warped after weeks in the water.
Thus armed, I approached the darkened doorway with as much confidence as one can
muster when coming face-to-face with an intruder. . . .
- 29 Immediately, a high-pitched screech pierced the gloom as a foul-smelling being
rushed past my face like a rifle shot, nicking my ear.
- 30 *I'm hit!* I thought, dropping the mallet and falling to the hard dirt floor. . . .
- 31 His masked eyes glowed like smoldering coals. His ears lay flat against his head. His
sharp teeth glistened, his whiskers twitched, and a sneer crossed his ratlike face.
- 32 It was the largest creature of its kind I've ever seen: a ferret as big as a Florida
alligator.

¹**geodesic dome:** a structure with a rounded roof

1

Based on paragraph 1, what does the word “obsured” mean?

- A** denied entry to
- B** raised high above
- C** existed far away from
- D** limited the visibility of

2

What idea do paragraphs 7 through 9 **mainly** contribute to the story?

- A** The narrator can find things that will help him.
- B** The Mississippi River is slowly losing water.
- C** The narrator knows his geography well.
- D** The United States offers opportunities for travel.

3

What does the phrase “keep your eyes peeled” mean as used in paragraph 9?

- A** to gaze longingly
- B** to view positively
- C** to look carefully
- D** to glance casually

4

The details in paragraphs 14 through 16 help convey a theme of the story by showing how the narrator

- A feels at home on the island
- B seems out of touch with nature
- C feels lonely on the island
- D longs to return home

5

The idiom “One man’s trash is another man’s treasure” means that what seems like waste to one person may be valuable to another. Which sentence from the story supports this idea?

- A “It was slow going, but using my hands, I fashioned a lean-to from willow whips—slender, limber branches torn from the trees that grew along the river.” (paragraph 5)
- B “I found a set of canisters, a bookshelf, a wicker wastebasket, a brass antelope, and a chipped yellow flowerpot.” (paragraph 14)
- C “*When you’re the only person for miles around, Fitch is as good a name as any.*” (paragraph 17)
- D “A soft *clink-clink* sound from my bedroom told me that the thief had found the money.” (paragraph 27)

6

Which detail shows a change in the direction of the story?

- A “*All and all*, I assured myself, *this is a pretty nice place to be.*” (paragraph 10)
- B “I dragged a chest of drawers to my hideout, and a picnic cooler that still contained ice.” (paragraph 14)
- C “*Enough’s enough!* I said to myself.” (paragraph 21)
- D “His masked eyes glowed like smoldering coals.” (paragraph 31)

GO ON

7

Which element does the author use to develop the narrator's viewpoint in the story?

- A** conflict between the characters
- B** flashback to the narrator's past
- C** dialogue between the characters
- D** description of the narrator's thoughts

GO ON

Directions

Read this article. Then answer questions 15 through 21.

Excerpt from “Roxie Laybourne: Feather Detective”

by Pamela Tuchscherer

- 1 Imagine having a job where you can create a new science, save lives, and solve murders. That’s what Roxie Laybourne achieved as a feather detective. She spent fifty-eight years at the Smithsonian National Museum of Natural History solving bird mysteries.
- 2 Born in 1910, Roxie Laybourne spent her childhood wandering through the fields and woods of Farmville, North Carolina. She followed anything that crawled or flew. Seeing a bird, she’d note the size and color and then ask her grandmother to identify it.
- 3 When she was ten years old, her friends wanted to be nurses or teachers. Not Roxie. She wanted to be a turkey vulture. Lying in the grass she’d watch the vultures soar above the trees and imagine herself riding the thermals.¹ Soon she was flying kites and building model airplanes that swooped through the air.
- 4 After high school, Roxie attended Meredith College in North Carolina, where she studied science and math. She was a serious student, but showed her independence by being the first girl on campus to wear blue jeans. She also mowed the grass and trapped rabbits to cook in the dorm.
- 5 With her love of natural history, Roxie spent weekends studying birds and animals on display at the North Carolina State Museum of Natural History. In time, a curator² offered her a volunteer job in the taxidermy department. She removed dead animals’ skeletons, muscles, and organs, then preserved their natural appearance by stuffing them with cotton and wire. Roxie learned patience as she carefully smoothed the birds’ feathers, so they lay naturally. She loved working with the staff. In her spirit of competitiveness, she didn’t want to be better than they were, she wanted to make herself better than she was.
- 6 In 1944, Roxie was hired to work in the Bird Division at the U.S. National Museum in Washington, D.C. She prepared bird specimens called study skins for the collection. Unlike the lifelike taxidermy mounts, these birds looked lifeless. Yet, Roxie felt she had to take special care. Each bird was a work of art, something to be treasured. . . .
- 7 As Roxie continued her work as one of the few women researchers at the museum, she developed an in-depth knowledge of birds by facing challenges and considering all possibilities. She didn’t feel like a woman breaking the barriers of science but was gratified when a curator told her that they never thought of her as a woman, just as a scientist.

GO ON

- 8 One day Roxie was asked to identify a set of bird feathers. She realized that to pinpoint the type of bird it came from, she'd have to discover a specific, distinguishing characteristic. Roxie had done similar work learning the family characteristics of plant structures while studying botany at George Washington University. With her knowledge of the methodology³ and knowing that keeping an open mind was the key to success, she was determined to find a feature that would tell her the family these particular feathers belonged to.
- 9 To find the subtle differences in the families' feathers, Roxie carefully examined them and drew precise pen-and-ink line drawings of what she saw on index cards. When she first started looking, she called it "going fishing," since she wasn't sure where to look.
- 10 Examining the downy portion of the feather under the microscope, Roxie discovered little branches, called barbs. These were divided into even smaller branches called barbules. Looking like rows of single cells or segments, they resembled tiny bamboo stalks with nodes, or knobs, all along the stalk. As Roxie examined different birds' feathers, she noticed that each species' nodes had unique shapes, like triangles, rings, or prongs. Similar to fingerprints, these "microstructures" were one of the keys in identifying many groups of birds from their feathers. . . .
- 11 Over time, Roxie's research improved aviation safety. Her findings assisted engineers in building safer aircraft by designing jet engines and windscreens more resilient to bird strikes. It also led to the creation of the first lab dedicated entirely to feather identification.
- 12 As an expert in her field, Roxie assisted the Fish and Wildlife Department in discovering what killed birds of prey. In the case she called the "Poisoned Bird Trio," Roxie tried to solve the mystery of what had killed a great horned owl. Her examination showed that the owl had eaten a red-tailed hawk. Inside the hawk's stomach, Roxie found a mash of magpie feathers. The key to what had killed the owl was Roxie's discovery that the magpie had eaten bugs that had been sprayed with an insecticide, a toxic chemical that then also poisoned the owl. "What I like about the job," said Roxie, "is you learn something new every day." . . .
- 13 Roxie never wrote a book on her feather science because she felt she'd never finished learning all there was to learn. She did feel, however, that she'd been allowed to share what she knew with others. With her positive and encouraging attitude, she held bird-skinning classes in the museum to train generations of young naturalists, and mentored many young field biologists. "They build on your knowledge," Roxie reflected. "You start at the bottom of a ladder, and each student goes higher but never gets to the top. But we keep climbing."

- 14 Today, the Smithsonian Feather Identification Lab processes ten thousand airplane bird strike cases a year. Even with DNA analysis, some samples are hard to identify correctly. For instance, in one puzzling case, which might be called “The Case of the Flying Deer,” DNA tests came back from the damaged airplane with a match for a white-tailed deer. Only by using Roxie’s methods of examining microscopic barbules in the sample were the researchers able to learn that a black vulture had fed on the deer before colliding with the plane.
- 15 Roxie’s observation, collection, and analysis skills, along with her persistence, helped her gain knowledge of thousands of birds in the Smithsonian collection. As the FBI’s Deedrick emphasized, “She was regarded as probably the foremost feather identification expert in the world.” Roxie’s work changed how the museum’s bird collection was used. To this day, specimens are not only used for basic scientific research, but also to solve life-and-death mysteries.

¹**riding the thermals:** gliding through the air on hot air that rises from the ground

²**curator:** a person in charge of museum collections

³**methodology:** a set of rules

GO ON

15 In paragraph 5, the phrase “spirit of competitiveness” refers to

- A** an expectation that her plans will succeed
- B** an interest in working cooperatively
- C** a desire to be the best she could
- D** a belief that patience is important

16 According to paragraphs 6 and 7, Roxie can **best** be described as a person who

- A** cared about her work and was constantly learning
- B** appreciated the support of other scientists at the museum
- C** decided to devote her life to preparing and studying birds
- D** preferred taxidermy to her job of preparing specimens

17 Advancements in one field of science often lead to advancements in other scientific fields. Which detail from the article **best** supports this idea?

- A** “To find the subtle differences in the families’ feathers, Roxie carefully examined them and drew precise pen-and-ink line drawings . . .” (paragraph 9)
- B** “Examining the downy portion of the feather under the microscope, Roxie discovered little branches, called barbs.” (paragraph 10)
- C** “Her findings assisted engineers in building safer aircraft by designing jet engines and windscreens more resilient to bird strikes.” (paragraph 11)
- D** “The key to what had killed the owl was Roxie’s discovery that the magpie had eaten bugs that had been sprayed with an insecticide . . .” (paragraph 12)

18

Which detail from the article **best** expresses a central idea of always gaining more knowledge?

- A** “Over time, Roxie’s research improved aviation safety.” (paragraph 11)
- B** “As an expert in her field, Roxie assisted the Fish and Wildlife Department in discovering what killed birds of prey.” (paragraph 12)
- C** “Roxie never wrote a book on her feather science because she felt she’d never finished learning all there was to learn.” (paragraph 13)
- D** “Only by using Roxie’s methods of examining microscopic barbules in the sample were the researchers able to learn that a black vulture had fed on the deer. . . .” (paragraph 14)

19

What is the **best** way paragraph 12 connects to paragraph 14?

- A** by describing how Roxie’s research was used to solve a mystery
- B** by comparing the feeding habits of different types of animals
- C** by suggesting that DNA analysis is superior to Roxie’s method
- D** by explaining that aircraft are frequently struck by birds during flights

20

What does paragraph 14 reveal about the author’s viewpoint?

- A** The author wants to persuade readers to visit a museum to see bird samples.
- B** The author wants to demonstrate that Roxie’s feather research is still important today.
- C** The author wants to inform readers about the danger birds face from airplanes.
- D** The author wants to prove that Roxie’s method of analysis is better than other kinds of analysis.

GO ON

Which claim by the author is **most** strongly supported with evidence throughout the article?

- A** Roxie wished to increase her understanding of the natural world.
- B** Roxie thought the work she was doing with feathers was important.
- C** Roxie believed that scientists should be receptive to new information.
- D** Roxie wanted students to keep studying despite natural limits to knowledge.

Directions

Read this story. Then answer questions 22 through 28.

Torix, whose full name is Vercingetorix, lives in Britain during the time of Roman rule. When Roman soldiers are mean to Torix, he is helped by the fort's commander, a Roman legate, or leader, named Gaius Valerius Atellus.

Excerpt from “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors”

by Diana Allor

- 1 It was just before the dinner hour, and the bustle of the square was winding down. As he let his mind play over the events of the day, Torix couldn't help but ponder his grandfather's admonition¹ from the morning. The antidote to² fifty enemies? How about 5,000 enemies! Yet, the Romans weren't all bad, it's true. Torix thought back to the shocking and horrifying encounter with Gaius Valerius Atellus that afternoon. The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors. And his kind, almost sad words as he put Torix back on his feet. He had seen the legate before, of course, although never so closely! The fort's commander often rested in the heat of the afternoon under an awning in this very square, playing *duodecim scripta*, a dice game, with a friend. Torix wondered how he had come to have such a festering wound on his leg when there was a hospital right in the fort. . . .
- 2 The next day, Torix placed a sealed crock, some unwashed wool, and a length of linen bandage in a small burlap sack. Grandfather looked at him quizzically but asked no questions. "You must have good reason, my son," he said. "Yes, good reason. You take what you need, I'll ask not."
- 3 "Thank you, Grandfather!" Torix responded, smiling broadly and rushing forward to give his grandfather a quick hug from behind before dashing out of the shop toward the town square.
- 4 Just as he had hoped, there sat the legate at a small table playing dice, his three-legged dog asleep at his feet. The legate was focused on the game, absentmindedly rubbing his bad leg. . . .
- 5 Without changing his posture the legate alternated his gaze between the quaking boy and burlap sack before he finally reached out and took what the boy offered. He examined the contents and looked back at Torix. "You're the boy from the wharf yesterday, aren't you?" he said, still scowling. . . . "And what am I to do with these things?" he asked, the irritation in his voice growing.
- 6 "It's honey and wool, sir. I noticed your leg was bothering you yesterday. It will help heal the infection."

GO ON

- 7 At this, the legate's face softened. He considered for a moment, and said, "I see." He looked back at the boy standing before him. "Thank you, child," he said sincerely, all traces of irritation gone. "I do thank you." . . .
- 8 Torix knelt down, removed the hobnailed *caliga*, the Roman boot, from the legate's foot, and slowly unwound the dirty bandage. The angry red wound on the front of his lower leg was large and deep and had begun to fester.
- 9 Torix soaked the clean cloth in the water and squeezed it out over the wound several times. Then he used the cloth to gently clean all around the open sore, getting as close to the edges as possible without causing pain. He tried to imitate what he had seen his grandfather do a hundred times. Once he had cleaned the wound, he took the wool from the bag and dipped it into the crock, saturating it with honey. When the wool plug was almost dripping, he laid it over the wound. Holding it in place, he used the clean strips of bandage to secure it, wrapping the strips tautly, but not too tight, around the injured leg. Then he put the *caliga* back on the legate's foot and looked up at him hopefully. The legate's face bore the soft expression of a young boy being cared for by a doting mother.
- 10 "The honey will help clear the infection, but this dressing will have to be changed every day. Maybe you can come to my grandfather's shop tomorrow?" Torix offered.
- 11 Remembering himself, the legate regained his authoritative bearing, "Yes, yes, of course. Down Dere Street, you say?" . . .
- 12 True to his word, Legate Gaius Valerius Atellus, with his faithful companion, the three-legged Tribus, visited Grandfather and Torix the next day—and the next, and the next. For three months, he and Tribus were familiar sights on Dere Street, visiting daily and enjoying the attention of the local shop owners. Surely the Roman doctor had returned from the north, Torix thought, yet the legate never mentioned going to the fort hospital. He had Magnus, the cobbler, make him a new pair of boots for the coming winter. He chatted daily with Flavius, the retired soldier who now sold pottery next door. And Ebbe always had a fresh sweet bun or loaf of barley bread for him along with a hot cup of tea. On many days he lingered longer than was strictly necessary in Grandfather's homey little shop, sipping tea and regaling Grandfather and Torix with stories of his many adventures. Although he would blush to admit it, he especially loved the rapt attention of the boy sitting at his feet, hanging on his every word. Finally, however, under the careful ministrations³ of Grandfather, the legate's wound healed completely. There was no more need for his daily visits. On the day Grandfather pronounced the leg completely strong again, the legate had an announcement of his own. . . .
- 13 "Torix," he said, "the fort is no place for a three-legged dog. Besides that, I am often required to travel on horseback away from the fort. The journeys are too much for poor Tribus. I need someone I trust to care for him. Do you think you could do that for me?" . . .

- 14 With Tribus by his side, life in Eboracum took a decidedly better turn for Torix. From that day forward, wherever he walked, Tribus, the distinctive, three-legged beacon of the legate's presence, led the way. Like a trumpeter heralding the presence of a king, Tribus alerted townsfolk and soldiers alike: "Heads up! Look smart! Here comes, not the legate, but his very special friend!"
- 15 The soldiers were now much less eager to tease Torix or play a cruel joke. Instead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather's shop, or even give him rides across town on their horses. When Torix thanked them, the soldiers would reply, "Pleased to help, young Torix," or "Anytime, little friend," or "Always at your service!" Truly, Torix had become *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*. He had found the antidote to 5,000 enemies, just as his grandfather had said—through just one friend.

¹**admonition:** advice

²**antidote to:** cure for

³**ministrations:** actions or services intended to help

GO ON

22

Paragraphs 1 through 6 **most** develop Torix's viewpoint by

- A showing how he analyzes a problem and devises a solution
- B revealing what he has learned by observing the legate
- C demonstrating how he interacts with other characters
- D presenting the close family relationships in his life

23

How does Gaius's attitude toward Torix change in paragraphs 5 through 7?

- A It shifts from annoyed to appreciative.
- B It shifts from anxious to relaxed.
- C It shifts from distracted to thoughtful.
- D It shifts from critical to proud.

24

Read this sentence from paragraph 9.

The legate's face bore the soft expression of a young boy being cared for by a doting mother.

What does the phrase "bore the soft expression" suggest about the legate?

- A He wishes to be reunited with his mother.
- B He becomes uninterested rather quickly.
- C He appears to be relaxed and pleased.
- D He has a carefree and childlike personality.

25

What change in plot occurs in paragraph 12?

- A Gaius buys goods from the local shops, which increases sales for the owners.
- B Gaius's leg wound heals, so the Roman doctor does not return to the fort.
- C Gaius makes visits to see Torix and Grandfather, and becomes friendly with them.
- D Gaius has the cobbler make him new boots, because the old ones were ruined during his injury.

26

What is the reason Torix wants to build a relationship with Gaius?

- A Torix thinks he can gain valuable experience in caring for Gaius's wounds.
- B Torix believes Gaius may solve his problem with the soldiers.
- C Torix wants to encourage Gaius to spend money on Dere Street.
- D Torix hopes Gaius will ask him to care for the three-legged dog, Tribus.

27

Which sentence **best** states a theme of the story?

- A Pets provide trustworthy companionship.
- B Big problems often require complex solutions.
- C Adults can learn important lessons from children.
- D Friendship can be a very powerful tool.

GO ON

28

This question is worth 2 credits.

Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

STOP

Grade 8
English Language Arts Test
Session 1
Spring 2026

Name: _____



New York State Testing Program

English Language Arts Test Session 2

Grade 8

Spring 2026

RELEASED QUESTIONS

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Session 2



TIPS FOR TAKING THE TEST

Here are some ideas to help you do your best:

- Read the whole passage before you answer the questions. Most questions will only make sense after you read the whole passage.
- You might need to read the passage more than once to answer a question.
- Read each question carefully. Take your time.
- A question may include a quote from a passage. You might need to review both the quote and the whole passage to answer the question.

When you write your answers

- make sure to answer the whole question;
- use examples or details from the text;
- write in complete sentences; and
- use correct spelling, grammar, capitalization, and punctuation.

For the last question in this test book, you may plan your writing on the Planning Page provided. However, do NOT write your final answer on the Planning Page. Write your final answer on the lined pages.

Directions

Read this story. Then answer questions 29 through 35.

Excerpt from *Fog Magic*

by Julia L. Sauer

- 1 Every soul in the little fishing village at the foot of the mountain had learned to accept the fog. It was part of their life. They knew that for weeks on end they must live within its circle. But they made no pretense of liking it. Those who tilled their little plots of land hated it when it kept their hay from drying. The men who fished dreaded it for it either kept them on shore altogether and cut down their meager earnings, or it made their hours on the sea more dangerous than ever. Only the lobster poachers who robbed honest men's lobster pots, or set their own out of season, liked it—the lobster poachers and small Greta. And with Greta it was more than liking. On days when the gray clouds of fog rolled in from the sea and spread over the village, she would watch it drift past the windows with a look on her small face that almost frightened her mother. . . .
- 2 As soon as Greta could walk, Gertrude found that she might as well put her housework aside on foggy days and give herself to minding her child. The first thin wraiths¹ of fog in the high pasture were enough to set her small daughter's eyes sparkling. By the time it hid the big rock at the top of the pasture, Greta would be working her way cautiously to the door; and when it drew close enough to blur their own out-buildings, she would be scampering down the pasture lane as fast as her uncertain feet could carry her. . . .
- 3 Greta was ten when she began to sense that she was looking for something within the fog. Until then it had only given her a happy feeling—just as the first snowflakes delighted some of the other girls and boys, or the first fall winds that set the birch leaves blowing. But from the day when she had gone alone to find old Rosie, the cow, nothing had been quite the same.

GO ON

4 The village of Little Valley lay on a narrow neck of land between two great arms of the sea. Like a lazy giant, North Mountain lay sprawled the full length of the peninsula until, at the very end, it sat up in a startled precipice² at the sight of the open sea. Years before, a number of villages had dotted the shore on either side. Now, only a few were left and those were dwindling in size as the men despaired of making a living by fishing. At the foot of the mountain and following the line of its base ran the highway. Here the Royal Mail, the grocery truck, the butcher and the tourist who had lost his way made his daily or weekly or chance trip down the neck to the sea and back again. But there was another road—a road less direct—filled with convenient curves—the old Post Road. This was the road the first settlers had built in the wilderness. They had come by sea, many of them, and made their little clearings near the shore. Gradually they had extended their clearings inland and in time, and with tremendous effort, they had threaded their holdings together on a narrow uncertain road through the spruce forest. With the new highway, generations later, had come new houses, away from the shore and more sheltered. Only cellar holes remained to mark the earlier homes.

5 This old Post Road was a joy to Greta. A part of it ran through her father's land. Even though it had fallen so low as to serve as a mere lane to the pastures, there was something grand and romantic about it still. Years of spring freshets³ had washed away the dirt. The stones were bare that had formed its foundation. To follow it was like walking in the bed of a dry mountain stream. Greta knew every stone, every curve of it for miles up over the high pastures and then down again toward the sea. This was the road her forefathers had traveled. Surely, she thought, it must lead somewhere worth going.

6 And then there was the day when old Rosie was particularly stubborn.

7 "Greta! Greta!" her mother called her from play. "Rosie isn't at the bars⁴ with the other cows. Your father's had a hard day getting the hay. You'd best go look for her before he does. You'll probably meet her on the way. You'll not need to go far." . . .

8 She found Rosie far off the Old Road and down at the cove. Rosie looked anything but guilty. Greta laughed. . . .

9 She hurried Rosie across the stones of the shore and up through the thick spruce trees to the clearing beyond. The fog was closing in rapidly. You didn't notice it in the woods, but out in the open it was already thick. Even Rosie began to look soft and furry and indistinct, like an imaginary cow that you tried to see in the clouds.

10 It was just as they turned out of the path to the cove and into the Old Road that Greta happened to look off to the south.

11 "Rosie, wait," she called sharply.

12 She caught her breath and stared. If only stupid old Rosie could see it, too. Surely there was the outline of a building. It was blurred and indistinct, but those straight upright lines, that steep angle—no spruces could look *that* way. Greta’s heart almost stopped beating, but she had no silly feeling of fear. Fog had always seemed to her like the magic spell in the old fairy tales—a spell that caught you up and kept you as safe, once you were inside it, as you would have been within a soap bubble. But this was stranger than anything she had ever seen before. Here was a house—a house where no house stood! Indistinct though it was, she could follow every line of it. A high sharp roof, a peaked gable, a little lean-to at the side. It was all there. Just such a house as those she saw every day in the village. . . .

13 It was the most exciting thing that had ever happened to her in her whole life. Rosie, far ahead, was mooing at the pasture bars, and Greta tore herself away to follow. Once inside the barn, she wished that she had stayed and gone closer.

¹**wraiths:** traces

²**precipice:** cliff

³**freshets:** streams

⁴**bars:** pasture bars, which are fence rails

GO ON

29 The description in paragraphs 1 and 2 of the difference between Greta's and other people's attitude about the fog shows that

- A** Greta behaves in ways that cause problems for her parents
- B** Greta does not care that the fog hinders people's work routines
- C** Greta is attracted to the fog in a special and mysterious way
- D** Greta is not concerned with other people's opinions of her

30 The author's word choice in paragraph 3 creates a tone of

- A** boredom, because Greta does not foresee anything interesting happening
- B** peacefulness, because the pasture is quiet and daily life is predictable
- C** suspense, because there is a hint of something unexpected to come
- D** contrast, because Greta realizes she is different from other children

31 What idea does paragraph 5 **most** contribute to the story?

- A** Greta's attachment to the area and its history
- B** the isolation of the land where Greta lives
- C** the beauty of the landscape where Greta lives
- D** Greta's curiosity about historical activities

32

In paragraph 8, Greta's reaction when she finds Rosie suggests that

- A she is amused by Rosie's independent spirit
- B she is happy to have found Rosie at all in the fog
- C she is surprised at how far from home Rosie had wandered
- D she is pleased that the search for Rosie brought her to this place

33

Which detail **best** supports a theme in the story?

- A "The men who fished dreaded it for it either kept them on shore altogether and cut down their meager earnings, or it made their hours on the sea more dangerous than ever." (paragraph 1)
- B "Years before, a number of villages had dotted the shore on either side. Now, only a few were left and those were dwindling in size . . ." (paragraph 4)
- C "Greta knew every stone, every curve of it for miles up over the high pastures and then down again toward the sea." (paragraph 5)
- D "Fog had always seemed to her like the magic spell in the old fairy tales—a spell that caught you up and kept you as safe . . ." (paragraph 12)

34

Read this sentence from paragraph 12.

She caught her breath and stared.

This sentence suggests that Greta is

- A frustrated by Rosie's behavior
- B stunned by the vision before her
- C worried about what she might find
- D exhausted by her journey to find Rosie

GO ON

Which detail from the story **best** foreshadows Greta's discovery?

- A** "... she began to sense that she was looking for something within the fog." (paragraph 3)
- B** "And then there was the day when old Rosie was particularly stubborn." (paragraph 6)
- C** "Rosie isn't at the bars with the other cows. . . . You'd best go look for her . . ." (paragraph 7)
- D** "It was the most exciting thing that had ever happened to her in her whole life." (paragraph 13)

Directions

Read this article. Then answer questions 36 through 42.

This is part of an interview with Sara Seager, who is an astrophysicist and professor. The interview was conducted in 2021. She studies galaxies, planets, stars, and other objects in space. She does some of her work with NASA, which stands for National Aeronautics and Space Administration. One of her areas of focus is the study of exoplanets, which are planets outside our solar system.

Excerpt from “Sara Seager”

by Bethany Ericson

- 1 Sara Seager is a planet hunter and a professor at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). Her work has helped us to identify planets outside our solar system. She has looked closely at the way light curves when exoplanets pass in front of the stars they orbit. Building on this research allowed her to study the environments of those distant worlds.
- 2 Currently Seager is focused on ways we can learn about the chemical composition of exoplanet atmospheres. Detecting the presence of certain organic molecules—like carbon dioxide, methane, and water vapor—could indicate conditions that would allow life to exist on other planets. Because of Seager’s innovative ideas and work using space telescopes and computer modeling, we have studied big hot planet atmospheres, and each discovery is paving the way for new detection technology and new ways to learn about rocky, Earth-like worlds.
- 3 Seager has been involved with a lot of space-based exoplanet search projects, including the MIT-led NASA mission TESS (a Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite), the miniature space satellite ASTERIA, and the developing Starshade Rendezvous Mission. Oh, and the search for life on Venus? She’s in charge of that too. . . .
- 4 **What are some good qualities for an astrophysicist? I’m sure being good at math and science helps, but what else?**
There was a period I actually didn’t pay great attention in science, but then later it clicked for me, as I needed it to explain the world. Computer programming is important, the ability to ask your own questions, curiosity, creativity, and persistence.
- 5 You definitely need the ability to face adversity—you’ll try a project and it might fail. Many kids are not given the opportunity to fail like that these days. Sports are helpful that way, because you can fail there—your skill and commitment have a consequence. There are mean people out there. Bullies are still around in different ways when you’re an adult; figure out how to identify and avoid them.

GO ON

6 It's also important to be able to take a huge idea and split it into the smallest parts you can. You don't decide to run a marathon, you focus on each step so you feel progress.

7 **What is a typical day at work for you?**

Half of my job is teaching and training—I teach students a variety of topics and I train students one-on-one on how to be a scientist. The other half of my job is doing research—both with my science team and on my own, like using data from the Hubble telescope and trying to interpret it and match it to computer models of exoplanet atmospheres. I belong to lots of teams that intersect in various ways on a lot of projects.

8 **How do you find exoplanets and decide what to study further?**

There are different ways to find exoplanets; many thousands have been discovered now. We are using the transit technique, that's when a planet goes in front of a star and it causes the light to dim a tiny amount in our view, using TESS (the Transiting Exoplanet Survey Satellite). For an idea of how much that can cover, the constellation Orion would fit in one TESS camera and TESS has four cameras. TESS took one year each to look at the northern and southern hemisphere skies and it's now in its third year, looking at tens of thousands of stars a month.

9 A brightness time-series is made for each star and then a computer searches for a tiny drop in brightness that might be caused by a planet. Each "planet candidate" must be validated or confirmed by other telescopes. . . .

10 Transits rely on lucky alignment, so not all exoplanets will show transit. Another planet-finding technique called direct imaging is not as mature as the transit technique. I'm also working on a project called Starshade, which would block starlight so we can see a planet directly. The idea is that we could make a giant, specially shaped screen to fly in formation with a space telescope tens of thousands of kilometers away in order to block star light from the telescope's view, so only planet light enters the telescope.

11 **So we have to assume extra-terrestrial life means . . . life like it would work on Earth?**

We can basically look for what life does here. It uses chemistry to store and release energy.

12 We breathe air and eat food and store energy in our bodies and then break down energy to walk and do things, and that creates byproduct gases. Signs of life won't necessarily indicate if it is microbes, plants, or intelligent life. (Even if we destroyed our planet for humans, the Earth would remain, and life would be seen here.)

I've been leading a study of a mission to Venus' atmosphere and look for signs of life and life itself. For that I have a core team that has different branches focused on different things, from biology to instrumentation. We're working on three options for missions—one that is small and fast, one that is medium and leisurely, and one that is large and slow. NASA, Russia, the Indian government, and private interests all want to go. Rocket Lab¹ says they want to go in mid 2023—which is fast. We have partnered up and are helping choose their instruments. It would be a small rocket—a probe that drops down and wouldn't last long, only a few minutes. Imagine throwing a rock like a baseball with sensors across a field. The whole thing might be 22 to 33 pounds (10 to 15 kg) with batteries and radio and what's left to do science with is just 4.5 to 11 pounds (2 to 4 kg).

¹**Rocket Lab:** a company that launches spacecraft into space, designs and manufactures satellites, and more

36 What does the phrase “paving the way,” as used in paragraph 2, show about Seager?

- A** She wants to be the first to discover new forms of life.
- B** She is trying to find out what is in the atmosphere of hot planets.
- C** She is creating opportunities for future exploration.
- D** She wants to learn more about exoplanets and their atmospheres.

37 How does the information in paragraphs 1 through 3 contribute to the understanding of the rest of the article?

- A** It explains the type of work Seager does as an astrophysicist.
- B** It identifies the different teams that Seager works with.
- C** It indicates that there may be life outside of our planet.
- D** It explains how to identify a planet outside our solar system.

38 In paragraph 5, what is the meaning of the word “adversity”?

- A** results from actions
- B** difficulties in life
- C** large work assignments
- D** opponents of an individual

39

Read this sentence from paragraph 5.

Sports are helpful that way, because you can fail there—your skill and commitment have a consequence.

What does this sentence reveal about Seager’s beliefs?

- A Commitment to a project is necessary.
- B Making mistakes in an activity is upsetting.
- C Consequences keep individuals from trying.
- D Failure is an essential part of learning.

40

Which idea **best** expresses a central idea of paragraph 6?

- A Success can be found by completing goals gradually.
- B People usually find that it is easier to pay attention to many little tasks.
- C People with big ideas can finish projects more quickly.
- D Completing a large goal is a good way to find success.

41

Which detail **best** shows how scientists determine if there could be life on an exoplanet?

- A “We can basically look for what life does here. It uses chemistry to store and release energy.” (paragraph 11)
- B “Signs of life won’t necessarily indicate if it is microbes, plants, or intelligent life.” (paragraph 12)
- C “For that I have a core team that has different branches focused on different things . . .” (paragraph 13)
- D “We have partnered up and are helping choose their instruments. It would be a small rocket . . .” (paragraph 13)

GO ON

In the article “In Defense of Curiosity,” Eleanor Roosevelt wrote, “In its simplest form, curiosity will help you to an all-around education.” How does Sara Seager represent this idea?

- A** Seager is a professor who spends part of each day teaching and training students to be scientists.
- B** Seager spends most of her time studying and researching in order to learn about exoplanets.
- C** Seager’s team uses different techniques and scientific methods to study exoplanets and atmospheres.
- D** Seager’s unique thinking and interests have driven her to learn about many different topics.

Directions

Read this article. Then answer questions 43 and 44.

Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*

by Douglas Whynott

- 1 Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places. They sit by groves of maple trees, sugar orchards some people call them or, more commonly, sugarbushes. Maples are among the most magnificent trees on earth, in a plant form known as the giver of life. We know this ever so truly now, in that trees extract carbon from the air and produce oxygen. I, for one, love to go into the forest and breathe the cool oxygenated air. Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow. The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremely hard and produces those striations¹ called bird's eye maple and tiger maple. During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside. And maple trees produce that soft green light in the summer season. Of course they most famously blaze spectacularly in the fall. Sugarhouses are there, by these places, by these trees. Sugarhouses help define those landscapes and the cultures built around them.
- 2 In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam. The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled.
- 3 I have wondered if there is the equivalent of the sugarhouse in any other form of agriculture. Apple orchards have their farm stands, and I know of some orchards where farm stands have grown into stores or where, in the fall, many people come to pick apples. But any other agricultures with the architectures of sugarhouses? Bruce Bascom said that within an hour's drive of his place in southwestern New Hampshire there are a thousand sugarhouses. He claims there are 20,000 maple sugarmakers in the United States, so if you subtract those who make syrup on a small scale in their kitchens or in backyards, there may be 15,000 sugarhouses in the United States. And many more in Canada, where much more syrup is made.

GO ON

- 4 The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber's dreams of pipes and steam. Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made. Some are small personal museums with collections of buckets, shoulder yokes, and sugar molds. Bruce told me of one in Quebec with a piano, a dining room, and chef, and quarters for workers during the sugar season.

¹**striations:** markings

43

This question is worth 2 credits.

What is the effect of the author’s word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

GO ON

This question is worth 2 credits.

The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

Directions
Read this story. Then answer questions 45 and 46.

Excerpt from *The Harvester*

by Gene Stratton-Porter

- 1 The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester¹ could have distinguished. Over his shoulder he carried a mattock,² and in the wagon were his clippers and an ax. Behind him came Betsy³ drawing the sap buckets and big evaporating kettles. Through the wood ranged Belshazzar, the craziest dog in all creation. He always went wild at sap time. Here was none of the monotony of trapping for skins around the lake. This marked the first full day in the woods for the season. He ranged as he pleased and came for a pat or a look of confidence when he grew lonely, while the Harvester worked.
- 2 At camp the man unhitched Betsy and tied her to the wagon and for several hours distributed buckets. Then he hung the kettles and gathered wood for the fire. At noon he returned to the cabin for lunch and brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap. While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras⁴ thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha⁵ for tea. Several times he stopped to cut an especially fine tree. . . .
- 3 He apologized to the first one he felled.⁶ “But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home. And no other house is possible for a creature of the woods but a cabin, is there? The birds use of the material they find here; surely I have the right to do the same. Seems as if nothing else would serve, at least for me. I was born and reared here, I’ve always loved you; of course, I can’t use anything else for my home.” . . .
- 4 He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over, and then, noticing a rapidly filling bucket, he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering sap. When he had made the round, he drove to the camp, filled the kettles, and lighted the fire. While it started he cut and scraped sassafras roots, and made clippings of tag alder,⁷ spice brush and white willow into big bundles that were ready to have the bark removed during the night watch, and then cured in the dry-house.

GO ON

- 5 He went home at evening to feed the poultry and replenish the ever-burning fire of the engine and to keep the cabin warm enough that food would not freeze. With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times. Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch. But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays.

¹**forester:** someone who cares for trees in a forest

²**mattock:** tool similar to a pick-axe

³**Betsy:** name of the Harvester's horse

⁴**sassafras:** tree with bark that is used for perfume and medicine

⁵**Onabasha:** a town that is close to where the Harvester lives

⁶**felled:** cut down a tree

⁷**tag alder:** tree used for food and medicine

45

This question is worth 2 credits.

In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

GO ON

Planning Page

You may PLAN your writing for question 46 here if you wish, but do NOT write your final answer on this page. Writing on this Planning Page will NOT count toward your final score. Write your final answer on Pages 23 and 24.



GO ON

46

This question is worth 4 credits.

What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

[illegible]

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal lines.

STOP

THE STATE EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK / ALBANY, NY 12234
2026 English Language Arts Tests Map to the Standards
Grade 8

Question	Type	Key	Points	Standard	Strand	Subscore	Secondary Standard(s)
Session 1							
1	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8L4	Language Standards	Reading	
2	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
3	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
4	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
5	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R9	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
6	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
7	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R6	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
15	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
16	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
17	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R9	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
18	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
19	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
20	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R6	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
21	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R8	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
22	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R6	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
23	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
24	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
25	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
26	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R8	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
27	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
28	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R9	Reading Standards for Literature	Writing to Sources	
Session 2							
29	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R6	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
30	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
31	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
32	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
33	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
34	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
35	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
36	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
37	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
38	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
39	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R6	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
40	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
41	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
42	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R9	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
43	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	
44	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R9	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	
45	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R8	Reading Standards for Literature	Writing to Sources	
46	Constructed Response		4	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-8R2	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	

*This item map is intended to identify the primary analytic skills necessary to successfully answer each question on the 2026 operational ELA test. However, each constructed-response question measures proficiencies described in multiple standards, including writing and additional reading and language standards. For example, two-point and four-point constructed-response questions require students to first conduct the analyses described in the mapped standard and then produce written responses that are rated based on writing standards. To gain greater insight into the measurement focus for constructed-response questions, please refer to the rubrics shown in the Educator Guides.

2-Credit Constructed-Response Rubric

Score	Response Features
2 Credits	The features of a 2-credit response are • Valid inferences and/or claims from the text where required by the prompt • Evidence of analysis of the text where required by the prompt • Relevant facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text to develop response according to the requirements of the prompt • Sufficient number of facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text as required by the prompt • Complete sentences where errors do not impact readability
1 Credit	The features of a 1-credit response are • A mostly literal recounting of events or details from the text as required by the prompt • Some relevant facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text to develop response according to the requirements of the prompt • Incomplete sentences or bullets
0 Credits*	The features of a 0-credit response are • A response that does not address any of the requirements of the prompt or is totally inaccurate • A response that is not written in English • A response that is unintelligible or indecipherable

- If the prompt requires two texts and the student only references one text, the response can be scored no higher than a 1.

* Condition Code A is applied whenever a student who is present for a test session leaves an entire constructed-response question in that session completely blank (no response attempted).

New York State Grades 6–8 Writing Evaluation Rubric

CRITERIA	NGLS	SCORE				
		4 Essays at this level:	3 Essays at this level:	2 Essays at this level:	1 Essays at this level:	0* Essays at this level:
CONTENT AND ANALYSIS: the extent to which the essay conveys ideas and information clearly and accurately in order to support analysis of topics or text(s)	W.2 R.1–9	—clearly introduce a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose —demonstrate insightful analysis of the text(s)	—clearly introduce a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose —demonstrate grade-appropriate analysis of the text(s)	—introduce a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose —demonstrate a literal comprehension of the text(s)	—introduce a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose —demonstrate little understanding of the text(s)	—demonstrate a lack of comprehension of the text(s) or task
COMMAND OF EVIDENCE: the extent to which the essay presents evidence from the provided text(s) to support analysis and reflection	W.2 R.1–8	—develop the topic with relevant, well-chosen facts, definitions, concrete details, quotations, or other information and examples from the text(s) —sustain the use of varied, relevant evidence	—develop the topic with relevant facts, definitions, details, quotations, or other information and examples from the text(s) —sustain the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety	—partially develop the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, some of which may be irrelevant —use relevant evidence with inconsistency	—demonstrate an attempt to use evidence, but only develop ideas with minimal, occasional evidence which is generally invalid or irrelevant	—provide no evidence or provide evidence that is completely irrelevant
COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE: the extent to which the essay logically organizes complex ideas, concepts, and information using formal style and precise language	W.2 L.3 L.6	—exhibit clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning —establish and maintain a formal style, using grade-appropriate, stylistically sophisticated language and domain-specific vocabulary with a notable sense of voice —provide a concluding statement or section that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented	—exhibit clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole —establish and maintain a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary —provide a concluding statement or section that follows from the topic and information presented	—exhibit some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions —establish but fail to maintain a formal style, with inconsistent use of language and domain-specific vocabulary —provide a concluding statement or section that follows generally from the topic and information presented	—exhibit little attempt at organization, or attempts to organize are irrelevant to the task —lack a formal style, using language that is imprecise or inappropriate for the text(s) and task —provide a concluding statement or section that is illogical or unrelated to the topic and information presented	—exhibit no evidence of organization —use language that is predominantly incoherent or copied directly from the text(s) —do not provide a concluding statement or section
CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS: the extent to which the essay demonstrates command of the conventions of standard English grammar, usage, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling	W.2 L.1 L.2	—demonstrate grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors	—demonstrate grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension	—demonstrate emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension	—demonstrate a lack of command of conventions, with frequent errors that hinder comprehension	—are minimal, making assessment of conventions unreliable

- If the prompt requires two texts and the student only references one text, the response can be scored no higher than a 2.
- If the student writes only a personal response and makes no reference to the text(s), the response can be scored no higher than a 1.
- Responses totally unrelated to the topic, illegible, or incoherent should be given a 0.
- A response totally copied from the text(s) with no original student writing should be scored a 0.

* Condition Code A is applied whenever a student who is present for a test session leaves an entire constructed-response question in that session completely blank (no response attempted).

Torix, whose full name is Vercingetorix, lives in Britain during the time of Roman rule. When Roman soldiers are mean to Torix, he is helped by the fort's commander, a Roman legate, or leader, named Gaius Valerius Atellus.

Excerpt from “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors”

by Diana Allor

- 1 It was just before the dinner hour, and the bustle of the square was winding down. As he let his mind play over the events of the day, Torix couldn't help but ponder his grandfather's admonition¹ from the morning. The antidote to² fifty enemies? How about 5,000 enemies! Yet, the Romans weren't all bad, it's true. Torix thought back to the shocking and horrifying encounter with Gaius Valerius Atellus that afternoon. The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors. And his kind, almost sad words as he put Torix back on his feet. He had seen the legate before, of course, although never so closely! The fort's commander often rested in the heat of the afternoon under an awning in this very square, playing *duodecim scripta*, a dice game, with a friend. Torix wondered how he had come to have such a festering wound on his leg when there was a hospital right in the fort. . . .
- 2 The next day, Torix placed a sealed crock, some unwashed wool, and a length of linen bandage in a small burlap sack. Grandfather looked at him quizzically but asked no questions. "You must have good reason, my son," he said. "Yes, good reason. You take what you need, I'll ask not."
- 3 "Thank you, Grandfather!" Torix responded, smiling broadly and rushing forward to give his grandfather a quick hug from behind before dashing out of the shop toward the town square.
- 4 Just as he had hoped, there sat the legate at a small table playing dice, his three-legged dog asleep at his feet. The legate was focused on the game, absentmindedly rubbing his bad leg. . . .
- 5 Without changing his posture the legate alternated his gaze between the quaking boy and burlap sack before he finally reached out and took what the boy offered. He examined the contents and looked back at Torix. "You're the boy from the wharf yesterday, aren't you?" he said, still scowling. . . . "And what am I to do with these things?" he asked, the irritation in his voice growing.
- 6 "It's honey and wool, sir. I noticed your leg was bothering you yesterday. It will help heal the infection."

- 7 At this, the legate's face softened. He considered for a moment, and said, "I see." He looked back at the boy standing before him. "Thank you, child," he said sincerely, all traces of irritation gone. "I do thank you." . . .
- 8 Torix knelt down, removed the hobnailed *caliga*, the Roman boot, from the legate's foot, and slowly unwound the dirty bandage. The angry red wound on the front of his lower leg was large and deep and had begun to fester.
- 9 Torix soaked the clean cloth in the water and squeezed it out over the wound several times. Then he used the cloth to gently clean all around the open sore, getting as close to the edges as possible without causing pain. He tried to imitate what he had seen his grandfather do a hundred times. Once he had cleaned the wound, he took the wool from the bag and dipped it into the crock, saturating it with honey. When the wool plug was almost dripping, he laid it over the wound. Holding it in place, he used the clean strips of bandage to secure it, wrapping the strips tautly, but not too tight, around the injured leg. Then he put the *caliga* back on the legate's foot and looked up at him hopefully. The legate's face bore the soft expression of a young boy being cared for by a doting mother.
- 10 "The honey will help clear the infection, but this dressing will have to be changed every day. Maybe you can come to my grandfather's shop tomorrow?" Torix offered.
- 11 Remembering himself, the legate regained his authoritative bearing, "Yes, yes, of course. Down Dere Street, you say?" . . .
- 12 True to his word, Legate Gaius Valerius Atellus, with his faithful companion, the three-legged Tribus, visited Grandfather and Torix the next day—and the next, and the next. For three months, he and Tribus were familiar sights on Dere Street, visiting daily and enjoying the attention of the local shop owners. Surely the Roman doctor had returned from the north, Torix thought, yet the legate never mentioned going to the fort hospital. He had Magnus, the cobbler, make him a new pair of boots for the coming winter. He chatted daily with Flavius, the retired soldier who now sold pottery next door. And Ebbe always had a fresh sweet bun or loaf of barley bread for him along with a hot cup of tea. On many days he lingered longer than was strictly necessary in Grandfather's homey little shop, sipping tea and regaling Grandfather and Torix with stories of his many adventures. Although he would blush to admit it, he especially loved the rapt attention of the boy sitting at his feet, hanging on his every word. Finally, however, under the careful ministrations³ of Grandfather, the legate's wound healed completely. There was no more need for his daily visits. On the day Grandfather pronounced the leg completely strong again, the legate had an announcement of his own. . . .
- 13 "Torix," he said, "the fort is no place for a three-legged dog. Besides that, I am often required to travel on horseback away from the fort. The journeys are too much for poor Tribus. I need someone I trust to care for him. Do you think you could do that for me?" . . .

14 With Tribus by his side, life in Eboracum took a decidedly better turn for Torix. From that day forward, wherever he walked, Tribus, the distinctive, three-legged beacon of the legate's presence, led the way. Like a trumpeter heralding the presence of a king, Tribus alerted townsfolk and soldiers alike: "Heads up! Look smart! Here comes, not the legate, but his very special friend!"

15 The soldiers were now much less eager to tease Torix or play a cruel joke. Instead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather's shop, or even give him rides across town on their horses. When Torix thanked them, the soldiers would reply, "Pleased to help, young Torix," or "Anytime, little friend," or "Always at your service!" Truly, Torix had become *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*. He had found the antidote to 5,000 enemies, just as his grandfather had said—through just one friend.

¹**admonition:** advice

²**antidote to:** cure for

³**ministrations:** actions or services intended to help

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

The author of “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” demonstrates the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority by describing the changes that occur in the way the soldiers treat Torix after he becomes friends with the legate. When he was unknown to Gaius, we can infer that Torix was a target of the soldiers. The text first introduces Gaius by saying “He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix’s tormentors. And his kind, almost sad words as he put Torix back on his feet.” By referring to the soldiers as “tormentors” and the need to help Torix “back on his feet”, it was clear that the soldiers targeted Torix. After his friendship with Gaius, “The soldiers were now much less eager to tease Torix or play a cruel joke. Instead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather’s shop, or even give him rides across town.” It appears that his relationship with Gaius, the person in authority, gave Torix a special status with the Roman soldiers.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author demonstrates the fact that in Ancient Rome socociety was valued by strength and authority because in the story the legate has the most authority than the soldiers. Like it says "The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors. And his kind, almost sad words as he put Torix back on his feet. He had seen the legate before, of course, although never so closely!" The soldiers get surprised that the legate is there, so that's why Torix decided that by being freinds with the legate he would have some respect. It also says "He had Magnus, the cobbler, make him a new pair of boots for the coming winter. He chatted daily with Flavius, the retired soldier who now sold pottery next door. And Ebbe always had a fresh sweet bun or loaf of barley bread for him along with a hot cup of tea." Everybody knew that the legate have authority so they gave the legate things like the boots, the bread and chatted with the retired soldier that know makes pottery.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

- *because in the story the legate has the most authority than the soldiers*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *The soldiers get surprised that the legate is there, so that's why Torix decided that by being freinds with the legate he would have some respect*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *“The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors. And his kind, almost sad words as he put Torix back on his feet. He had seen the legate before, of course, although never so closely!”*
- *“He had Magnus, the cobbler, make him a new pair of boots for the coming winter. He chatted daily with Flavius, the retired soldier who now sold pottery next door. And Ebbe always had a fresh sweet bun or loaf of barley bread for him along with a hot cup of tea.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author demonstrates this idea by showing how Torix bravely helped Giaus and in reward he gave him respect and his three-legged dog. The writer states, ““It’s honey and wool, sir. I noticed your leg was bothering you yesterday. It will help heal the infection.” And then the author writes, “I need someone I trust to care for him. Do you think you could do that for me?” This shows how Torix helping Giaus made Giaus believe in him . Giaus valued Torix's authority.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

- *by showing how Torix bravely helped Giaus and in reward he gave him respect and his three-legged dog*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *““It’s honey and wool, sir. I noticed your leg was bothering you yesterday. It will help heal the infection.”*
- *“I need someone I trust to care for him. Do you think you could do that for me?”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Well ne piece of evidence is that in the entire reading torix is seen as weak. But then when he becomes friends with Gaius he is seen as a high member of authority. Another piece of evidence is that in paragraph 15 it shows the soldiers were now almost scared to be mean to torix. After he became friends with the leader he was seen as a "higher up of authority"

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

- *After he became friends with the leader he was seen as a “higher up of authority”*

The response provides a sufficient number of relevant details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *in the entire reading torix is seen as weak. But then when he becomes friends with Gaius he is seen as a high member of authority*
- *the soldiers were now almost scared to be mean to torix*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author showed that Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority by showing how the soldiers respected Torix after he became friends with Gaius. One example of this is when it said ““Heads up! Look smart! Here comes, not the legate, but his very special friend!”” This shows that the soldiers now respect him because of his friendship with Gaius.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

- *by showing how the soldiers respected Torix after he became friends with Gaius*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *““Heads up! Look smart! Here comes, not the legate, but his very special friend!””*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

"The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors."

"nstead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather's shop, or even give him rides across town on their horses."

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"The legate! He remembered the annoyed look he gave those soldiers, Torix's tormentors."*
- *"nstead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather's shop, or even give him rides across town on their horses."*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

he soldiers were now much less eager to tease Torix or play a cruel joke. Instead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather’s shop, or even give him rides across town

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *he soldiers were now much less eager to tease Torix or play a cruel joke. Instead, they jumped at the opportunity to carry heavy water buckets for him, or haul shipments from the wharf back to his grandfather’s shop, or even give him rides across town*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors*” to demonstrate the idea that ancient Roman society valued strength and authority.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Thats kings are stronger than worriors.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *Thats kings are stronger than worriors*

28 Ancient Roman society valued strength and authority. In “Vercingetorix, King Over Warriors,” how does the author demonstrate this idea? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The way the author demonstrates is by telling the story as best as he can. and two supporting details is “You must have good reason, my son,” he said. “Yes, good reason. You take what you need, I’ll ask not.” and The legate was focused on the game, absentmindedly rubbing his bad leg.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *The way the author demonstrates is by telling the story as best as he can. and two supporting details is “You must have good reason, my son,” he said. “Yes, good reason. You take what you need, I’ll ask not.” and The legate was focused on the game, absentmindedly rubbing his bad leg*

Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*

by Douglas Whynott

- 1 Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places. They sit by groves of maple trees, sugar orchards some people call them or, more commonly, sugarbushes. Maples are among the most magnificent trees on earth, in a plant form known as the giver of life. We know this ever so truly now, in that trees extract carbon from the air and produce oxygen. I, for one, love to go into the forest and breathe the cool oxygenated air. Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow. The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremely hard and produces those striations¹ called bird's eye maple and tiger maple. During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside. And maple trees produce that soft green light in the summer season. Of course they most famously blaze spectacularly in the fall. Sugarhouses are there, by these places, by these trees. Sugarhouses help define those landscapes and the cultures built around them.
- 2 In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam. The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled.
- 3 I have wondered if there is the equivalent of the sugarhouse in any other form of agriculture. Apple orchards have their farm stands, and I know of some orchards where farm stands have grown into stores or where, in the fall, many people come to pick apples. But any other agricultures with the architectures of sugarhouses? Bruce Bascom said that within an hour's drive of his place in southwestern New Hampshire there are a thousand sugarhouses. He claims there are 20,000 maple sugarmakers in the United States, so if you subtract those who make syrup on a small scale in their kitchens or in backyards, there may be 15,000 sugarhouses in the United States. And many more in Canada, where much more syrup is made.

4 The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber's dreams of pipes and steam. Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made. Some are small personal museums with collections of buckets, shoulder yokes, and sugar molds. Bruce told me of one in Quebec with a piano, a dining room, and chef, and quarters for workers during the sugar season.

¹**striations:** markings

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

The author's word choice in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*" has a warm and cozy effect on the reader. It helps the reader visualize the idyllic setting of New England by describing the scene in detail: "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road." Further description is added with "Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open," which invites the reader into this warm and cozy environment.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from the Sugar Season", creates an effect where the reader finds themselves imagining a very homey and warm place. The author describes sugarhouses and the surrounding environment around them, which makes the reader imagine what a sugarhouse is like. "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap" (2). The depictions of an unpaved road and woodpiles gives a sense of being close to nature. "Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled" (2). Snow is associated with cold and harshness, but the addition of a fire burning makes it sound very comfortable. The author uses depictions of a sugarhouse with specific word choice to make the reader imagine how good being around a sugar house would be like.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *creates an effect where the reader finds themselves imagining a very homey and warm place*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *The author describes sugarhouses and the surrounding environment around them, which makes the reader imagine what a sugarhouse is like*
- *The depictions of an unpaved road and woodpiles gives a sense of being close to nature*
- *Snow is associated with cold and harshness, but the addition of a fire burning makes it sound very comfortable*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap"*
- *"Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The effect of the authors word choice in paragraph 2 makes you image the place mample syrup is made. For example, "a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire". This is telling you about how a sugarhouse and how it looks and what it has. Another example is, "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road". This makes you image a little sugarhouse next to a road maybe in the middle of nowhere. That is why the effect of the authors word choice in paragraph 2 makes you image the place mample syrup is made.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *makes you image the place mample syrup is made*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire"*
- *"The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The effect of the author's words in paragraph 2 is that he is drawing the reader in the story by stating all the details about a sugar house even if they are unnecessary. "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby." and "Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap." These quotes are stating how the author described the house by a very visual way and even though the details are not required it can make you visualize what it is.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *he is drawing the reader in the story by stating all the details about a sugar house*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby."*
- *"Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" are to inform the reader of sugar houses. One of the word choices are "cottage-sized building" this wording describes the sugar house. This is why the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" are to inform the reader of sugar houses.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *are to inform the reader of sugar houses*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *"cottage-sized building"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The authors word choice tells you more detail and make the person reading this more in the moment. It also hooks the reader and makes them feel there.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *tells you more detail and make the person reading this more in the moment. It also hooks the reader and makes them feel there*

The response does not provide two relevant details from the text for support.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The authors word choice in paragraph 2 is about people and maple syrup. Its talking about "a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam." They are using horses to pull the wagon with maple syrup inside."Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap." The animals are helping the humans. Lastly the door to thr syrup is always open no matter what. Even when its raining, snowing or when its cold, warm, freezing it doesnt matter because its inside a factory and when its done people are ready to take a sample to check if its ok.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam."*
- *"Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap."*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to describe the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

It vibrant becuae i now it is and i can tell by reading paragraph 1.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *It vibrant becuae i now it is and i can tell by reading paragraph 1*

- 43 What is the effect of the author's word choices in paragraph 2 of *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

Maple trees prosess carbon during photosynthesis,making carbohydats that they later covert to suger when the warm weather comes and the sap beins to flow.any other agricltures with the architectures of sugerhouse Bruce bascom said that an hour's drive of his place in southwestern New hampshire there are a thousand sugerhouses.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *Maple trees prosess carbon during photosynthesis,making carbohydats that they later covert to suger when the warm weather comes and the sap beins to flow.any other agricltures with the architectures of sugerhouse Bruce bascom said that an hour's drive of his place in southwestern New hampshire there are a thousand sugerhouses*

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

“Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*” supports the idea that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful by describing the design of the sugar shacks, and how they have both aesthetic and functional characteristics as they convert maple sap into maple syrup. In terms of their aesthetic appeal, the author states “sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber’s dreams of pipes and steam. Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made.” In terms of their functional use, the author tells us that “a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam.... There is syrup ready to be sampled.” The culture around rural maple syrup production seamlessly combines beauty with utility.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The belief that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" by talking about how the sugarhouses can look very different depending on how the owner wants it to look. In the article, it says, "Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places." Sugarhouses are useful for making different maple products, and have beautiful scenery. Also in the article, it says, "Bruce told me of one in Quebec with a piano, a dining room, and chef, and quarters for workers during the sugar season." This sugarhouse is beautifully filled with music and smells of food. It is useful as a restaurant too.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *by talking about how the sugarhouses can look very different depending on how the owner wants it to look*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *Sugarhouses are useful for making different maple products, and have beautiful scenery*
- *It is useful as a restaurant too*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places."*
- *"Bruce told me of one in Quebec with a piano, a dining room, and chef, and quarters for workers during the sugar season."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use two details from the article to support your response.

The English artist William Morris belived that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. This idea is reflected in "Excerpt from the Sugar Season" by giving an example with Maple Trees. Maple trees are in fact very beautifl trees, that provide us with maple sap which is used for maple syrup. According to the text it states "The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremley hard and produces those straitions called bird's eye maple and tiger maple. The text also states that "During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow-the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside. In addition William Morris belived that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful so he gave an example with the maple tree and how its not just a beautiful tree but it also provides us with sap that is then used to make syrup.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *by giving an example with Maple Trees [...] and how its not just a beautiful tree but it also provides us with sap that is then used to make syrup*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremley hard and produces those straitions called bird's eye maple and tiger maple*
- *"During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow-the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

William Morris believes designs should be beautiful and useful. This is reflected in the article by in paragraph one it said "Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places, they sit by groves of maple trees, sugar orchards."

It also says "Sugarhouses are there, by these places, by these trees. Sugarhouses help define these landscapes and cultures built around them."

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *by in paragraph one it said*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places, they sit by groves of maple trees, sugar orchards."*
- *"Sugarhouses are there, by these places, by these trees. Sugarhouses help define these landscapes and cultures built around them."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

This idea that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from The Sugar Season". First, the text says, "In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam". This supports the claim because these things are useful but are made to look beautiful. Also, the text states "Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap".

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

- *these things are useful but are made to look beautiful*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *"In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

44

The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The way she thinks that things are both beautiful and usful is by saying that the suger houses bring together a maple farm with its beauty and usefulness

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in “Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*.”

- *by saying that the suger houses bring together a maple farm with its beauty and usefulness*

The response does not provide two relevant details from the text for support.

This response includes a complete sentence where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

This idea reflects to the excerpt because in the story it states that "Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made." it also states that "The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners."

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- "Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made."
- "The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners."

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text that describes how the idea that people should design things to be beautiful and useful is reflected in "Excerpt from *The Sugar Season*."

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

44 The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

So people can buy the product so you can get more money. So people can be more interested to buy that product.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *So people can buy the product so you can get more money. So people can be more interested to buy that product*

44

The English artist William Morris believed that people should design things to be both beautiful and useful. How is this idea reflected in *The Sugar Season*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

he is tryin to say is.dont do something you dont want to do in your life.if you want to do something that intrests you,go for and work hard to achieve that goal.in paragraph people that sit by grooves and other trees are sugar bushes.thats something they like to do.and in paragraph 2 they talk about people developing the syrup or things that comes from the trees.in that paragraph it shows that people are working hard to make something like a ,masterpiece

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *he is tryin to say is.dont do something you dont want to do in your life.if you want to do something that intrests you,go for and work hard to achieve that goal.in paragraph people that sit by grooves and other trees are sugar bushes.thats something they like to do.and in paragraph 2 they talk about people developing the syrup or things that comes from the trees.in that paragraph it shows that people are working hard to make something like a ,masterpiece*

Excerpt from *The Harvester*

by Gene Stratton-Porter

- 1 The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester¹ could have distinguished. Over his shoulder he carried a mattock,² and in the wagon were his clippers and an ax. Behind him came Betsy³ drawing the sap buckets and big evaporating kettles. Through the wood ranged Belshazzar, the craziest dog in all creation. He always went wild at sap time. Here was none of the monotony of trapping for skins around the lake. This marked the first full day in the woods for the season. He ranged as he pleased and came for a pat or a look of confidence when he grew lonely, while the Harvester worked.
- 2 At camp the man unhitched Betsy and tied her to the wagon and for several hours distributed buckets. Then he hung the kettles and gathered wood for the fire. At noon he returned to the cabin for lunch and brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap. While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras⁴ thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha⁵ for tea. Several times he stopped to cut an especially fine tree. . . .
- 3 He apologized to the first one he felled.⁶ "But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home. And no other house is possible for a creature of the woods but a cabin, is there? The birds use of the material they find here; surely I have the right to do the same. Seems as if nothing else would serve, at least for me. I was born and reared here, I've always loved you; of course, I can't use anything else for my home." . . .
- 4 He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over, and then, noticing a rapidly filling bucket, he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering sap. When he had made the round, he drove to the camp, filled the kettles, and lighted the fire. While it started he cut and scraped sassafras roots, and made clippings of tag alder,⁷ spice brush and white willow into big bundles that were ready to have the bark removed during the night watch, and then cured in the dry-house.

5 He went home at evening to feed the poultry and replenish the ever-burning fire of the engine and to keep the cabin warm enough that food would not freeze. With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times. Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch. But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays.

¹**forester:** someone who cares for trees in a forest

²**mattock:** tool similar to a pick-axe

³**Betsy:** name of the Harvester's horse

⁴**sassafras:** tree with bark that is used for perfume and medicine

⁵**Onabasha:** a town that is close to where the Harvester lives

⁶**felled:** cut down a tree

⁷**tag alder:** tree used for food and medicine

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

The author of “Excerpt from *The Harvester*” shows that living off the land is difficult by detailing the extraordinary amount of work required by the harvester each day. After preparing his materials to harvest sap he “brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap.” Just when you think he might take a break while the sap collects, “he dug roots in the sassafras thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha for tea.” His work continues in the evening, when he “went home [...] to feed the poultry and replenish the ever-burning fire of the engine and to keep the cabin warm enough that food would not freeze.” In his “spare” time he harvested a tree for building a cabin and collected bundles of wood to work on in late hours of the night while he tended the sap. Living successfully off the land seems to require completing a never-ending cycle of urgent tasks.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author shows that living off the land is difficult by explaining the hard day that the harvester goes through just to stay alive. In the article, it says, "While it started he cut and scraped sassafras roots, and made clippings of tag alder, spice brush and white willow into big bundles that were ready to have the bark removed during the night watch, and then cured in the dry-house." The harvester was working hard just to get the sap ready, not even selling it yet. Also in the article, it says, " With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times." Even though the harvester had been working all day, he still had to stay up with the sap to get it ready.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text "Excerpt from *The Harvester*" to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

- *by explaining the hard day that the harvester goes through just to stay alive*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *The harvester was working hard just to get the sap ready, not even selling it yet*
- *Even though the harvester had been working all day, he still had to stay up with the sap to get it ready*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"While it started he cut and scraped sassafras roots, and made clippings of tag alder, spice brush and white willow into big bundles that were ready to have the bark removed during the night watch, and then cured in the dry-house."*
- *" With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

45

In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author shows how living of the land is difficult by showing how diffuclt it is is to work constanly. The text says "He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over." This shows how he has to work non-stop. The author states "But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays." This shows that he never stopped working and he always had something to work on or do.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text "Excerpt from *The Harvester*" to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

- *by showing how diffuclt it is is to work constanly*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over."*
- *"But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author says that living off the land is difficult because you have to make and sell your own things to live. For example in the text it states " But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home". Another example is "While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha".

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text "Excerpt from *The Harvester*" to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

- *because you have to make and sell your own things to live*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *" But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home"*
- *"While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author shows living off land is hard by explaining how hard it is to go through the land. One detail in paragraph one says, "The harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering road that only a forester could have distinguished." Another in paragraph where text says, "Through the wood ranged Belshazzar, the craziest dog in all creation."

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text "Excerpt from *The Harvester*" to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

- *by explaining how hard it is to go through the land*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *"The harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering road that only a forester could have distinguished."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

It shows that living off the land is difficult because in paragraph 1 it states "The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished".

It also states in paragraph 4 "He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over..."

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished"*
- *"He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over..."*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text "Excerpt from *The Harvester*" to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

45

In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

he cut down trees to build a home and he has no electronics

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response only provides one relevant detail from the text for support.

- *he cut down trees to build a home*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text “Excerpt from *The Harvester*” to explain how the author shows that living off the land is difficult.

This response includes a complete sentence where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

45

In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

He a framer and he need the money

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *He a framer and he need the money*

- 45 In *The Harvester*, how does the author show that living off the land is difficult? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

That they're are crazy dogs in the woods and have to hunt for food in the woods and could get hurt.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *That they're are crazy dogs in the woods and have to hunt for food in the woods and could get hurt*

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

Possible Exemplary Response:

Have you ever wondered how the maple syrup you pour on your pancakes made the unlikely journey from a tree in the forest to a bottle or tin in the grocery store and then onto your table? The two texts, “Excerpt from *Sugar Season*” by Douglas Whynott and “Excerpt from *The Harvester*” by Gene Stratton-Porter share the process of converting maple sap into maple syrup. They share a central idea that maple syrup is a product valued both culturally and

commercially. Although they share a central idea, the texts develop their ideas differently. “Excerpt from *Sugar Season*” is an article that highlights the place sugar production holds in the culture of the maple woods, while the story “Excerpt from *The Harvester*” narrates a story about a single man’s experiences harvesting maple sap and boiling it down for syrup.

Douglas Whynott starts his article with a brief acknowledgement of the idyllic beauty surrounding sugarhouses, the locations sprinkled throughout sugar orchards that convert sap to syrup. Whynott states “Sugarhouses are located in some of the most beautiful places. They sit by groves of maple trees, sugar orchards some people call them or, more commonly, sugarbushes.” He continues “And maple trees produce that soft green light in the summer season. Of course they most famously blaze spectacularly in the fall. Sugarhouses are there, by these places, by these trees. Sugarhouses help define those landscapes and the cultures built around them.” His descriptions of a maple grove help the reader visualize the setting. This description tells us what nature provides, without getting into any human contribution.

Whynott also describes the scientific basis of the flowing sap we convert to syrup, saying “Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow. ... During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside.” This describes an amazing photochemical reaction where the trees take sunshine, convert it first to carbon, then carbohydrates, which the tree converts to sap as the weather warms. The tree, again, does all of this without human intervention.

So where do humans come in? Human intervention is needed to convert maple sap from the tree to maple syrup for your table. That process is described in great detail in “Excerpt from *The Harvester*,” which details a day in the life of one individual who harvests maple sap to produce maple syrup. The narrative starts as the harvester is walking through the woods with his horse, who was “drawing the sap buckets and big evaporating kettles,” some of the equipment needed to convert the sap into syrup. The story continues “for several hours [he] distributed buckets. Then he hung the kettles and gathered wood for the fire.” This labor-intensive process continues, as the harvester next “brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap.”

After completing other tasks, “noticing a rapidly filling bucket, he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering sap. When he had made the round, he drove to the camp, filled the kettles, and lighted the fire.” Making syrup is clearly an arduous process. Finally, the harvester “returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times. Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch.” These descriptions of a day in the life of the harvester sound like an overwhelming amount of work that requires care and diligence to create the final product.

These details suggest that although, as described by Whynott, the maple tree has an almost mystical relationship to the sun and air to create a flow of sap, the human component as described by Stratton-Porter required in converting sap to maple syrup is hard and daunting work. This contrasts with the idyllic description of sugar houses described by Whynott. His description leaves out the work required and instead focuses on the idiosyncratic beauty: “The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber’s dreams of pipes and steam.”

The two texts, “Excerpt from *Sugar Season*” by Douglas Whynott and “Excerpt from *The Harvester*” by Gene Stratton-Porter share a central idea that maple syrup is a product valued both culturally and commercially. Whynott develops his ideas through exploring the beauty of maple groves and their attendant sugarhouses, creating a painterly depiction that helps the reader visualize where syrup is manufactured. Stratton-Porter develops his ideas through detailing the hard, arduous work that goes into converting sap to syrup. The article makes the reader want to visit sugarhouses, while the story makes one thankful that someone else is willing to do the work to get maple syrup onto the table.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 4-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The article "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" by Douglas Whynott and the story "Excerpt from The Harvester" By Gene Stratton-Porter both have a large focus on the production of syrup. Although very different forms of writing, both pieces of writing express the intricate, yet underappreciated process that goes into the creation of maple syrup. Both authors cover the process of making maple syrup, and documents the honest, but hard work that goes into such a seemingly simple ingredient. In their own respective way, they cover how sap is collected, prepared, then cooked. Although the texts share a common idea, it is both presented, and developed in different ways. The primary difference that puts the texts apart is the form of literature they are. Due to the fact that "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" is an article, and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is a story the tactics that the authors use to convey their ideas are significantly different from each other.

Both authors present the central idea by informing the reader of how sap is made, but the way they do that is different. The Harvester presents and develops this central idea by showing the story of a man who harvests sap and cooks syrup. It shows how long it takes him and every part of the process. For example, "At camp the man unhitched Betsy and tied her to the wagon and for several hours distributed buckets. Then he hung the kettles and gathered wood for the fire. At noon he returned to the cabin for lunch and brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap." This represents the beginning of the very long process of how maple syrup is made, and shows that just collecting the sap is a long task. This is significant because the way the author represents these ideas in the a narrative format which goes into the harvester's perspective of how he collects sap, then creates syrup. On the other hand, the article presents the central idea by informing the reader about maple trees and how sap works. For instance, "Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow. The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremely hard and produces those striations called bird's eye maple and tiger

GUIDE PAPER 1b

maple. During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside." This shows how intricate the process of sap being made is, and shows how special the order of events leading up to maple syrup is so special. This is important because the explanation of how sap is made using details develops the article's main idea using straight facts. In summary, the author of the story presents the central idea by using a narrative format to inform the reader about the process of making syrup, while the author of the article explains facts to have the reader understand how special maple syrup really is.

The central idea of the article and story are developed very differently as the story uses a chronological order of events that happen in the story, and the article uses description and facts to let the reader understand early, then expand on why the creation of maple syrup is so special later in the article. According to the fourth paragraph of the article, "The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber's dreams of pipes and steam. Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made. Some are small personal museums with collections of buckets, shoulder yokes, and sugar molds." This uses examples of sugarhouses to let the reader know how many forms that sugarhouses, used to make maple syrup, have and how diverse and special the creation of maple syrup is. These examples also are a showcase of the effort people put into making maple syrup as well. This matters because the author develops the idea about the processes involved with the development of syrup. The author initially sets a foundation of understanding with information, and expands on the speciality of the process. On the other hand, the author of the story develops their idea by using the chronological events of making maple syrup, through the eyes of a harvester. The fifth paragraph states, "With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times. Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch. But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays." This connects how the harvester spends significant amounts of time and effort to gather sap, then spends time cooking it, reinforcing how much effort the harvester puts into making maple syrup. In conclusion, the author of the article develops the central idea by showing examples of sugarhouses that represent effort and the diversity of maple syrup production, and the author of the story uses the experiences of the harvester to develop the central idea.

GUIDE PAPER 1c

To finalize, the two texts "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" by Douglas Whynott and "Excerpt from The Harvester" by Gene Stratton-Porter are very different in formatting, but both represent the same ideas while presenting it in different ways. The Sugar Season presents and develops this central idea by giving the reader various types of information on sugarhouses, how they look, and the variety they possess. But on the other hand, The Harvester presents and develops the central idea using the events of the story to represent the effort it takes for someone to naturally prepare maple syrup. Showing and describing how the harvester gathers sap by hand, how long it takes, and the cooking that makes sap into syrup.

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *The article "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" by Douglas Whynott and the story "Excerpt from The Harvester" By Gene Stratton-Porter both have a large focus on the production of syrup. Although very different forms of writing, both pieces of writing express the intricate, yet underappreciated process that goes into the creation of maple syrup. Both authors cover the process of making maple syrup, and documents the honest, but hard work that goes into such a seemingly simple ingredient. In their own respective way, they cover how sap is collected, prepared, then cooked. Although the texts share a common idea, it is both presented, and developed in different ways. The primary difference that puts the texts apart is the form of literature they are. Due to the fact that "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" is an article, and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is a story the tactics that the authors use to convey their ideas are significantly different from each other*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *Although the texts share a common idea, it is both presented, and developed in different ways. The primary difference that puts the texts apart is the form of literature they are*
- *This represents the beginning of the very long process of how maple syrup is made, and shows that just collecting the sap is a long task. This is significant because the way the author represents these ideas in the a narrative format which goes into the harvester's perspective of how he collects sap, then creates syrup*
- *This shows how intricate the process of sap being made is, and shows how special the order of events leading up to maple syrup is so special. This is important because the explanation of how sap is made using details develops the article's main idea using straight facts*
- *the story uses a chronological order of events that happen in the story, and the article uses description and facts to let the reader understand early, then expand on why the creation of maple syrup is so special later in the article*

GUIDE PAPER 1d

- *uses examples of sugarhouses to let the reader know how many forms that sugarhouses, used to make maple syrup, have and how diverse and special the creation of maple syrup is*
- *the author develops the idea about the processes involved with the development of syrup. The author initially sets a foundation of understanding with information, and expands on the speciality of the process*
- *the author of the story develops their idea by using the chronological events of making maple syrup, through the eyes of a harvester*
- *the harvester spends significant amounts of time and effort to gather sap, then spends time cooking it, reinforcing how much effort the harvester puts into making maple syrup*
- *the two texts “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” by Douglas Whynott and “Excerpt from The Harvester” by Gene Stratton-Porter are very different in formatting, but both represent the same ideas while presenting it in different ways*

The response develops the topic with relevant, well-chosen details from the texts, and sustains the use of varied, relevant evidence.

- *“At camp the man unhitched Betsy and tied her to the wagon and for several hours distributed buckets. Then he hung the kettles and gathered wood for the fire. At noon he returned to the cabin for lunch and brought back a load of empty syrup cans, and barrels in which to collect the sap.”*
- *“Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow. The wood of the sugar maple, also called rock maple, is extremely hard and produces those striations called bird’s eye maple and tiger maple. During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside.”*
- *“The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic, but sugarhouses are as varied as the imaginations of their owners. Some are swaybacked and mossy old sheds handed down through the generations. Some are as smartly carpentered as new barns. Others are plumber’s dreams of pipes and steam. Some are restaurants and sugarhouses in one, where people go for pancakes and to watch the syrup being made. Some are small personal museums with collections of buckets, shoulder yokes, and sugar molds.”*
- *“With an oilcloth and blankets he returned to camp and throughout the night tended the buckets and boiling sap, and worked or dozed by the fire between times. Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch. But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning.

- *Although*
- *Both authors*
- *yet*
- *but*

GUIDE PAPER 1e

- *In their own respective way*
- *Due to the fact*
- *For example*
- *This represents*
- *This is significant*
- *On the other hand*
- *This shows*
- *This is important*
- *In summary*
- *According to*
- *This matters*
- *This connects*
- *In conclusion*
- *To finalize*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using grade-appropriate, stylistically sophisticated language and domain-specific vocabulary with a notable sense of voice.

- *both pieces of writing express the intricate, yet underappreciated process that goes into the creation of maple syrup*
- *narrative format*
- *harvesters perspective*
- *intricate the proccess*
- *chronological order of events*
- *showcase*
- *reinforcing how much effort*

The response provides a concluding statement that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented.

- *To finalize, the two texts “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” by Douglas Whynott and “Excerpt from The Harvester” by Gene Stratton-Porter are very different in formatting, but both represent the same ideas while presenting it in different ways. The Sugar Season presents and develops this central idea by giving the reader various types of information on sugarhouses, how they look, and the variety they posess. But on the other hand, The Harvester presents and develops the central idea using the events of the story to represent the effort it takes for someone to naturally prepare mayple syrup. Showing and describing how the harvester gathers sap by hand, how long it takes, and the cooking that makes sap into syrup*

GUIDE PAPER 1f

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *tacitcs*
- *mayple*
- *harvesters perspective*
- *proccess*
- *explanation*
- *iea*
- *inicially*
- *speciality*
- *makng*
- *posess*
- Punctuation

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

A central idea from both "The Sugar Season" and "The Harvester" is that man needs nature to survive and thrive in the world. This idea is developed differently in both texts as in "The Sugar Season" it's developed by the author explaining how there's an immense amount of sugarhouses in the United States, and how those sugarhouses use nature to benefit civilians. "In The Harvester", the narrator is seen cutting down trees-using nature-to his benefit.

In "The Harvester", the narrator cuts down trees to make himself a house. This supports the central idea that man needs nature perfectly, and paragraph 3 supports the claim by stating, "But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home.... I was born and reared here, I've always loved you; of course, I can't use anything else for my home." This evidence demonstrates his desire to use the wood from trees for a house, for his benefit, for his own personal gain. The central idea is heavily developed here. Moreover, in paragraph 5, the text states, "But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays." This reinforces the idea that the narrator uses nature for his own wellbeing. He takes twigs of willow and uses their bark for his own need.

In "The Sugar Season", the author, Whynott, is seen using the trees he describes for his own need, as supported by the central idea. The first instance of this is in paragraph 1, where the text states, "Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow." This shows how the maple tree's carbon created carbohydrates which man can convert into sugar using sap from trees. This whole process is for human's comfort and need, supporting the central idea that man really can't thrive without nature. To add on, in paragraph 3, the text quotes, "He claims there are 20,000 maple sugarmakers in the United States, so if you subtract those who make syrup on a small scale in their kitchens or in backyards, there may be 15,000 sugarhouses in the United States." This evidence shows how there are thousands of people who rely on nature, specifically trees, to make sugar. Sugar is commonly used all throughout the world, so really, these trees are supporting the entire globe. Human beings can't have something as simple as sugar without trees; and at the end of the day, human's can't live without nature.

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *A central idea from both "The Sugar Season" and "The Harvester" is that man needs nature to survive and thrive in the world. This idea is developed differently in both texts as in "The Sugar Season" it's developed by the author explaining how there's an immense amount of sugarhouses in the United States, and how those sugarhouses uses nature to benefit civilians. "In The Harvester", the narrator is seen cutting down trees-using nature-to his benefit.*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *This evidence demonstrates his desire to use the wood from trees for a house, for his benefit, for his own personal gain*
- *the narrator uses nature for his own wellbeing. He takes twigs of willow and uses their bark for his own need*
- *This shows how the maple tree's carbon created carbohydrates which man can convert into sugar using sap from trees*
- *This whole process is for human's comfort and need, supporting the central idea that man really can't thrive without nature*
- *there are thousands of people who rely on nature, specifically trees, to make sugar. Sugar is commonly used all throughout the world, so really, these trees are supporting the entire globe. Human beings can't have something as simple as sugar without trees; and at the end of the day, human's can't live without nature*

The response develops the topic with relevant, well-chosen details from the texts, and sustains the use of varied, relevant evidence.

- *“But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home.... I was born and reared here, I’ve always loved you; of course, I can’t use anything else for my home.”*
- *“But when the kettles were freshly filled the Harvester sat beside them and carefully split tender twigs of willow and slipped off the bark ready to be spread on the trays.”*
- *“Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow.”*
- *“He claims there are 20,000 maple sugarmakers in the United States, so if you subtract those who make syrup on a small scale in their kitchens or in backyards, there may be 15,000 sugarhouses in the United States.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole.

- *This supports the central idea*
- *This evidence demonstrates*
- *Moreover*
- *This reinforces*
- *The first instance of this*
- *This shows*
- *To add on*
- *at the end of the day*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using precise language domain-specific vocabulary.

- *Man needs nature to survive and thrive*
- *for his benefit, for his own personal gain*
- *the maple tree’s carbon created carbohydrates which man can convert into sugar using sap from trees*
- *This whole process is for human’s comfort and need*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *at the end of the day, human’s can’t live without nature*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

- *amout*
- *sugarhouses uses nature*
- *human’s can’t live*
- Punctuation

GUIDE PAPER 3a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea shared by “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” is their love for the trees. Each author present this central idea by making readers visualize the trees. The central idea developed differently in the article and the story because in the article, the author gives use information about sugarhouses and what they are, while in the story the author talks about what he does with the sassafras.

The central idea of “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” is that the author like to imagine things about sugarhouses. For example, “Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap.” The words, “possibly” and “maybe” shows that the author is asumming whats on a sugarhouse, which means the author isn't a hundred percent sure about whats on the sugarhouse. In addition, “There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby.” The words, “maybe” and “bbuckets hanging around” shows that the author is so interested by the sugarhouse that the author is picturing buckets hanging around on the trees.

The central idea of “Excerpt from The Harvester” is to show how passionate the harvester is about his job. For example, “He apologized to the first one he felled.” The words, “apologized” and “first one he felled” shows that the harvester is apologizing to th tree he is about to cut, which means he cares about the tree but it's his job. In addition, “I’ve always loved you; of course, I can’t use anything else for my home.” The words, “loved you” and “can’t use anything” shows how the harvester loves the tree alot and how he uses the tree to build his home and he wouldn't know what to do if the tree didn't exist.

GUIDE PAPER 3b

The central idea is developed differently in the article and the story because in the article the author has no experience working in a sugarhouse while in the story the harvester works with the sassafras tree everyday. For example, "Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap." The words, "possibly" and "maybe" show that the author is trying to imagine how workers in a sugarhouse operate, which shows that the author has no experience working in a sugarhouse. In addition, "This marked the first full day in the woods for the season." The words, "Marked" and "season" shows that it's a routine for the harvester to show up in a town and distribute buckets.

Therefore, The central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is the share similarities and differences in loving their trees.

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *The central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is their love for the trees. Each author present this central idea by making readers visualize the trees. The central idea developed differently in the article and the story because in the article, the author gives use information about sugarhouses and what they are, while in the story the author talks about what he does with the sassafras*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *the author is assuming what's on a sugarhouse, which means the author isn't a hundred percent sure about what's on the sugarhouse*
- *the author is so interested by the sugarhouse that the author is picturing buckets hanging around on the trees*
- *The central idea of "Excerpt from The Harvester" is to show how passionate the harvester is about his job*
- *the harvester is apologizing to the tree he is about to cut, which means he cares about the tree but it's his job*
- *the harvester loves the tree a lot and how he uses the tree to build his home and he wouldn't know what to do if the tree didn't exist*
- *in the article the author has no experience working in a sugarhouse while in the story the harvester works with the sassafras tree everyday*
- *the author is trying to imagine how workers in a sugarhouse operate, which shows that the author has no experience working in a sugarhouse*
- *it's a routine for the harvester to show up in a town and distribute buckets*

GUIDE PAPER 3c

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *“Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap.”*
- *“There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby.”*
- *“He apologized to the first one he felled.”*
- *“I’ve always loved you; of course, I can’t use anything else for my home.”*
- *“Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap.”*
- *“This marked the first full day in the woods for the season.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *While*
- *For example*
- *which means*
- *In addition*
- *shows that*
- *because*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *visualize the trees*
- *imagine things*
- *a hundred percent sure*
- *picturing buckets hanging around on the trees*
- *passionate*
- *the author is trying to imagine how workers in a suagrhouse operate*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *Thefore, The central idea shared by “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” is the share similarities and diferences in loving their trees*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *Each author present*

GUIDE PAPER 3d

- *gives use information*
- *talkes*
- *like to imagine*
- *asumming whats*
- *a hundred percent*
- *bbuckets*
- *th*
- *alot*
- *experince*
- *a suagrhouse*
- *hervester*
- *Thefore*
- *the share*
- *diferences*

GUIDE PAPER 4a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea between "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is to use the resources we have available to us, however Gene Stratton-Porter of *The Harvester* approaches this in a more entertaining way compared to Douglas Whynott's informational way in *The Sugar Season*. For example, in paragraph 2 & 3 of *The Harvester*, it states, "Several times he stopped to cut an especially fine tree. He apologized to the first one he felled. 'But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home.'" In paragraph 2 & 3 of *The Sugar Season*, it states, "During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside... There is syrup ready to be sampled." These show how we should be using resources from nature, *The Harvester* uses a character that we learn about, in this case learning they use resources to build a house, and in *The Sugar Season* it tells us exactly how we can use the resources such as sap to make syrup and use it. Also from *The Harvester* in paragraph 2 it states, "While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha for tea." In *The Sugar Season* it states in paragraph 1, "Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow." These show how the character of *The Harvester* is used to portray us using resources, and how the information of maple trees bring us to learn more about them, and help us understand them. Both "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" tell us to utilize our resources, however in either an information approach, or an entertaining approach.

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *The central idea between "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is to use the resources we have available to us, however Gene Stratton-Porter of The Harvester approaches this in a more entertaining way compared to Douglas Whynott's informational way in The Sugar Season*

GUIDE PAPER 4b

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *Gene Stratton-Porter of The Harvester approaches this in a more entertaining way compared to Douglas Whynott's informational way in The Sugar Season*
- *These show how we should be using resources from nature*
- *The Harvester uses a character that we learn about, in this case learning they use resources to build a house, and in The Sugar Season it tells us exactly how we can use the resources such as sap to make syrup and use it*
- *These show how the character of The Harvester is used to portray us using resources, and how the information of maple trees bring us to learn more about them, and help us understand them*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *"Several times he stopped to cut an especially fine tree. He apologized to the first one he felled. 'But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home.'"*
- *"During the time when the sap runs, the maple tree produces gas internally, which pressurizes the tree and aids in the sap flow—the maple is one of those rare trees that have air inside... There is syrup ready to be sampled."*
- *"While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras thicket to fill orders and supply the demand of Onabasha for tea."*
- *"Maple trees process carbon during photosynthesis, making carbohydrates that they later convert to sugar when the warm weather comes and the sap begins to flow."*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *however*
- *For example*
- *These show*
- *In this case*
- *Also*
- *both*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *resources we have available to us*
- *resources from nature*
- *entertaining way*
- *informational way*
- *portray us using resources*
- *utilize our resources*

GUIDE PAPER 4c

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *Both “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” tell us to utilize our resources, however in either an information approach, or an entertaining approach*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

- *aproaches*

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is what life is like for a syrup harvester. Both excerpts share ideas about this trade that develop throughout each story.

In the story "Excerpt from The Sugar Season," the author shows the reader what a sugarhouse is like. The author gives describing details about these buildings. Some examples are, "The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic..." and "...a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam." Both of these details show how the idea of this excerpt, which is to explain sugarhouses of the sap and syrup industry, relates to the main idea of the other story.

In the story "Excerpt from The Harvester," the author shows the reader what a day in the life of a sap harvester is like. The author uses details like, "While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras..." and "Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch." Both of these details support the central idea of both passages.

Both of these passages explain some aspect of the sap harvesting industry. One explains what sugarhouses are like and what they are used for, while another explains the work that sap harvesters have to do. Both focus on the same aspect and industry, but explain different parts of it.

In conclusion, the central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is what life is like for a syrup harvester. Both stories explain this trade and an aspect within it.

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *The central idea shared by “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” is what life is like for a syrup harvester. Both excerpts share ideas about this trade that develop throughout each story*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *The author gives describing details about these buildings*
- *Both of these details show how the idea of this excerpt, which is to explain sugarhouses of the sap and syrup industry, relates to the main idea of the other story*
- *the author shows the reader what a day in the life of a sap harvester is like*
- *Both of these passages explain some aspect of the sap harvesting industry. One explains what sugarhouses are like and what they are used for, while another explains the work that sap harvesters have to do. Both focus on the same aspect and industry, but explain different parts of it*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *“The image of the sugarhouse, smokestack, and steam is iconic...”*
- *“...a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam.”*
- *“While the buckets filled at the dripping trees, he dug roots in the sassafras...”*
- *“Toward the end of boiling, when the sap was becoming thick, it had to be watched with especial care so it would not scorch.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *In the story*
- *Some examples are*
- *Both of these details show*
- *the author shows the reader*
- *Both of these passages explain*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *The sap and syrup industry*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *In conclusion, the central idea shared by “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” is what life is like for a syrup harvester. Both stories explain this trade and an aspect within it*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

- *describing details*

GUIDE PAPER 6a

46

What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea shared in both "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is the idea that hard work pays off.

In "Excerpt from The Harvester", the author shows that hard work pays off in the lines, "He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over, and then, noticing a rapidly filling bucket, he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering sap. When he had made the round, he drove to the camp, filled the kettles, and lighted the fire." I can imagine how hard this work would be for one man. He lived his life in the forest and knows how to work for what he needs, like the syrup he is making, as shown in the quote I pulled from the text.

In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season", the author shows that hard work pays off in the quote, "In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam." These sugar houses must've been hard to engineer, as there are many different mechanisms involved, such as the venting system and smokestack. By the people working hard to build these sugarhouses, they are able to get the recourse they need; syrup.

In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season", the author uses a non-fictional approach to describe the central idea by discussing a real life building, or a sugar house. The author of this text also describes how sugar is made in these houses. In "Excerpt from The Harvester", the author uses a fictional approach of telling the central idea by telling the tale of a man who lives in the forest. The man chops down trees for syrup.

Though both "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" share two different, but very similar stories, they both do a great job at explaining one thing. And that thing is how much effort must be put into your work.

GUIDE PAPER 6b

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *The central idea shared in both “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” is the idea that hard work pays off*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *I can imagine how hard this work would be for one man. He lived his life in the forest and knows how to work for what he needs, like the syrup he is making*
- *These sugar houses must’ve been hard to engineer, as there are many different mechanisms involved, such as the venting system and smokestack. By the people working hard to build these sugarhouses, they are able to get the recourse they need; syrup*
- *the author uses a non-fictional approach to describe the central idea by discussing a real life building, or a sugar house*
- *the author uses a fictional approach of telling the central idea by telling the tale of a man who lives in the forest*

The response partially develops the topic with some textual evidence, and uses relevant evidence with inconsistency.

- *“He chopped steadily until the tree crashed over, and then, noticing a rapidly filling bucket, he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering sap. When he had made the round, he drove to the camp, filled the kettles, and lighted the fire.”*
- *“In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *I can imagine*
- *by imagining*
- *Though both*
- *And that thing*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *Hard work pays off*
- *hard to engineer*
- *recourse they need*
- *non-fictional approach*
- *fictional approach*

GUIDE PAPER 6c

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *Though both “Excerpt from The Sugar Season” and “Excerpt from The Harvester” share two different, but very similar stories, they both do a great job at explaining one thing. And that thing is how much effort must be put into your work*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *cetral*
- *envolved*
- *disscussing*
- *desrcibes*
- *the central diea*
- Punctuation

GUIDE PAPER 7a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season", and "Excerpt from The Harvester", both the article and the story show how unique and comforting harvesting sap can be.

In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season", the author describes the maple trees and how astonishing it is to see how they work. He states, "Maples are among the most magnificent trees on earth, in a plant form known as the giver of life. We know this ever so truly now, in that trees extract carbon from the air and produce oxygen". He is amazed by how a sugar maple tree thrives on Earth. He also describes what a sugarhouse is, and he sees it as a cozy, save place, with sap awaiting you. He says, "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpave road... Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning,".

In "Excerpt from The Harvester", the author uses narratives to describe the harvester's adventure during sugar season. He tells us about the help he has of his horse and dog, as he ventures out into the sugar maple forest. He says, "Behind him came Betsy drawing the sap buckets and evaporating kettles. Through the wood ranged Belshazzar, the craziest dog in all creation". He also describes his use of the sap and trees, and how grateful he is for them. He states, "He apologized to the first one he felled. "But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home".

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season", and "Excerpt from The Harvester", both the article and the story show how unique and comforting harvesting sap can be*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *the author describes the maple trees and how astonishing it is to see how they work*
- *He is amazed by how a sugar maple tree thrives on Earth. He also describes what a sugarhouse is, and he sees it as a cozy, save place, with sap awaiting you*

GUIDE PAPER 7b

- *the author uses narratives to describe the harvester's adventure during sugar season. He tells us about the help he has of his horse and dog, as he ventures out into the sugar maple forest*
- *He also describes his use of the sap and trees, and how grateful he is for them*

The response partially develops the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, some of which may be irrelevant.

- *"Maples are among the most magnificent trees on earth, in a plant form known as the giver of life. We know this ever so truly now, in that trees extract carbon from the air and produce oxygen"*
- *"The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpave road... Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning,"*
- *"Behind him came Betsy drawing the sap buckets and evaporating kettles. Through the wood ranged Belshazzar, the craziest dog in all creation"*
- *"He apologized to the first one he felled. "But it certainly must be legitimate for a man to take enough of his trees to build a home"*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *He states*
- *He also describes*
- *He says*
- *He tells us*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *unique and comforting*
- *how astonishing it is to see how they work*
- *amazed by how a sugar maple tree thrives on Earth*
- *he sees it as a cozy, save place*
- *the author uses narratives to describe the harvester's adventure*
- *ventures out*

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *save place*
- *unpave*
- Punctuation

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

both passages share similiar ideas of humble people making syrup in very unmodern places. they present these ideas by using imagery and very descriptive words. one deatil from Excerpt from The Harvester is "The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished." this sets up a very relaxed mood and creates an image of a very unmodernised place by using imagery and descriptive language. and in Excerpt from The Sugar Season the author writes "In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam. The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled."this quote also creates a very relaxed moodand sets up a location similiar to the one from the harvester and the author does this with descriptive language and imagery.

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *both passages share similiar ideas of humble people making syrup in very unmodern places. they present these ideas by using imagery and very descriptive words*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *this sets up a very relaxed mood and creates an image of a very unmodernised place by using imagery and descriptive language*
- *this quote also creates a very relaxed moodand sets up a location similiar to the one from the harvester and the author does this with descriptive language and imagery*

The response partially develops the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, and uses relevant evidence with inconsistency.

- *“The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished.”*
- *“In the minds of most people, those who know something about maple syrup and its production, a sugarhouse is a cottage-sized building with a smokestack for a wood fire and a cupola or some other sort of opening for venting steam. The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled.”*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *by using*
- *and in*
- *this quote also*

The response establishes but fails to maintain a formal style, with inconsistent use of language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *humble people making syrup in very unmodern places*

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension.

- *similiar*
- *deatil*
- *unmodernised*
- Capitalization
- Punctuation

GUIDE PAPER 9a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

A central idea that is used in both the article and the story is sugarhouses and gathering sap from trees. The authors share this idea in different and similar ways as with Gene Stratton-Porter he creates more of a third person view talking about this man during sugar season but with Douglas Whynott he speaks with facts instead of a sort of story. Either way, both authors make a very descriptive writing, making you imagine what is happening and making you picture the words in your head. Some details to support this claim are "The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished. Over his shoulder he carried a mattock, and in the wagon were his clippers and an ax. Behind him came Betsy drawing the sap buckets and big evaporating kettles." This was pulled from "The Harvester" by Gene Stratton-Porter. Another detail to support my claim is from the article, "The Sugar Season" by Douglas Whynott, "The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled." As you can see the details from each story are very descriptive and make you picture the atmosphere in your head.

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *A central idea that is used in both the article and the story is sugarhouses and gathering sap from trees. The authors share this idea in different and similar ways as with Gene Stratton-Porter he creates more of a third person view talking about this man during sugar season but with Douglas Whynott he speaks with facts instead of a sort of story*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *both authors make a very descriptive writing, making you imagine what is happening and making you picture the words in your head*

GUIDE PAPER 9b

The response partially develops the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, some of which may be irrelevant.

- *“The Harvester walked through deep leaves and snow covering the road that only a forester could have distinguished. Over his shoulder he carried a mattock, and in the wagon were his clippers and an ax. Behind him came Betsy drawing the sap buckets and big evaporating kettles.”*
- *“The sugarhouse sits alongside a road, maybe an unpaved country road. There is a woodpile outside and maybe buckets hanging on trees nearby. Possibly there is a horse, maybe a draft horse used to pull a wagon and gather maple sap. Snow covers the ground, a fire is burning, and the sugarhouse door is open. There is syrup ready to be sampled.”*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *Either way*

The response establishes but fails to maintain a formal style, with inconsistent use of language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *sort of story*
- *This was pulled from*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows generally from the topic and information presented.

- *As you can see the details from each story are very discriptive and make you picture the atmosphere in your head*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *entral*
- *artical*
- *make a very discriptive writing*

GUIDE PAPER 10a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea shared by the article and story is how syrup is made. In the story, the author adds how the protagonist is making syrup, "he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering the sap." Furthermore, in the article the writer is described how syrup is made and where it is made. The story backs up the article with more details.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *The central idea shared by the article and story is how syrup is made*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *the protagonist is making syrup*
- *the writer is described how syrup is made and where it is made*
- *The story backs up the article with more details*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence, which is generally invalid or irrelevant.

- *"he struck the ax in the wood and began gathering the sap."*

The response exhibits little attempt at organization.

- *the author adds*
- *Furthermore*

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise or inappropriate for the texts and task.

GUIDE PAPER 10b

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *protagnosit*
- *is described how*

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

A central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is that trees can produce good things for the environment. In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" it tells us how the syrup is being produced the sugarhouse. In "Excerpt from The Harvester" it tells us how you can make the sap and kettles from the tree itself. One of them tells us how syrup produced in a sugar house, and the other tells us how it is made in trees.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose.

- *A central idea shared by "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" and "Excerpt from The Harvester" is that trees can produce good things for the environment*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *One of them tells us how syrup produced in a sugar house, and the other tells us how it is made in trees*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence.

- *In "Excerpt from The Sugar Season" it tells us how the syrup is being produced the sugarhouse*
- *In "Excerpt from The Harvester" it tells us how you can make the sap and kettles from the tree itself*

The response exhibits little attempt at organization.

- *One of them [...] and the other*

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise for the texts and task.

- *You can make the sap and kettles from the tree itself*

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *how syrup produced*
- *is being produced the sugarhouse*

GUIDE PAPER 12a

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

That the havester and the sugar season is that they both are making some thing sweet or getting something sweet to make. And they present it by a sugar house and a havester in a forset. The havester is going to the maple trees to get the sap. And the suger season is on a farm. That there both doing something to make them happy and make other people happy.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose.

- *That the havester and The Sugar Season is that they both are making some thing sweet or getting something sweet to make*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *The havester is going to the maple trees to get the sap*
- *the suger season is on a farm*
- *there both doing something to make them happy and make other people happy*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence, which is generally invalid or irrelevant.

- *they present it by a sugar house and a havester in a forset*

The response exhibits little attempt at organization.

- *And they present it*

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise or inappropriate for the texts and task.

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

GUIDE PAPER 12b

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *some thing*
- *forset*
- *havester*
- *suger*
- *there both*

GUIDE PAPER 13

46 What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

The central idea of this is The Harvester journey on what he does.
The author shows this by explaining what he is going to do next.

Score Credit 0 (out of 4 credits)

This response demonstrates a lack of comprehension of the texts or task.

- *The central idea of this is The Harvester journey on what he does. The author shows this by explaining what he is going to do next*

46

What is a central idea shared by *The Sugar Season* and *The Harvester*? How does each author present this central idea? How is the central idea developed differently in the article and the story? Use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- identify a central idea shared by the article and the story
- describe how each author presents this central idea
- explain how the central idea is developed differently in the article and the story
- use details from **both** the article and the story to support your response

They both almost represent eachother becuae they both do almost the same thing and its very similar how they do it and they both explain how its done and stories of it.also the stories are very similar cause they both have a situation about the thing there doing so it makes it very similar.

Score Credit 0 (out of 4 credits)

This response demonstrates a lack of comprehension of the texts or task.

- *They both almost represent eachother becuae they both do almost the same thing and its very similar how they do it and they both explain how its done and stories of it.also the stories are very similar cause they both have a situation about the thing there doing so it makes it very similar*